



Human Resource Policy Manual

BANK OF JAMAICA

Human Resource Policy Manual

PURPOSE AND OVERVIEW

This is the official statement of the Bank of Jamaica's Human Resource Policies. It is the responsibility of each manager and supervisor to administer these policies consistently and impartially. The policies are applicable to all staff members irrespective of status. The policies form a part of each employee's terms and conditions of service. It is therefore the responsibility of each member of staff to be aware and adhere to the rules and regulations stipulated within.

The Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration on the directives of the Management Committee is responsible for revisions to this manual in cooperation with the Human Resources (HR) Division. To ensure that the manual is accessible to all employees, a copy is available on the Bank's INTRANET.

The Bank of Jamaica retains the right to exercise judgment in establishing and administering human resource policies, practices and procedures; to make changes in them and the right to take whatever action necessary in the Bank's judgment for the achievement of the standards of performance and goals of the institution.

BANK OF JAMAICA

APRIL 2008

Selected policies updated: October 2021

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RULES AND ORDERS

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank's code of conduct is reflected in the **Rules and Orders**. In the absence of specific rules, employees are still expected to behave with decorum/professionalism and to use good judgement and discretion. Whenever there is doubt regarding the expected standards of behaviour, the employee should consult with his/her supervisor or Head of Department.

2.0 Dress

- 2.1 Every member of staff must be professionally attired at work and when representing the Bank locally or overseas.
- 2.2 All female members of staff who have been issued uniforms are required to wear them each working day. In exceptional circumstances, when uniforms are not worn, staff members must be professionally attired.

3.0 Punctuality and Attendance

Amended November 2011

- 3.1 Members of staff shall attend work at such time as stipulated by the Bank and shall remain on duty for the period of time stipulated.

Staff members' punctuality and attendance will be recorded through the Bank's Electronic Punctuality and Attendance System (EPAS). A staff member's attendance at work will be verified by the palm reader at the relevant point of access. For the purposes of recording punctuality, on arrival at work, each employee must present his/her Staff Identification Card to the card reader at the point of access to their respective department.

- 3.2 Staff members who present their ID card at the designated card reader any time after their stipulated time of arrival will be regarded as late e.g. 8:30:01. Arrival at work ten or more minutes after the stipulated time of arrival for three days within one week will result in the relevant disciplinary action being taken. With the exception of Protection Officers, an employee arriving two and a half hours or more after the stipulated time without prior approval shall be deemed absent unless otherwise determined by his/her Departmental Head. Staff members on arrival should therefore immediately report to their Departmental Head. Protection Officers are required to adhere strictly to stipulated working hours.
- 3.3 Upon exiting the Bank throughout the work day, all members must present their cards at the card reader.
- 3.4 Each employee is entitled to one hour for lunch. The employee's immediate supervisor will determine the specific time period during which this entitlement may be exercised.

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4.0 Absence

- 4.1 A member of staff who is absent from his/her post without prior permission, except in unavoidable circumstances, will be liable to disciplinary action.

5.0 Notice of Change of Address

- 5.1 Each member of staff shall notify the HR Division, in writing, of any change of address within a week of such change.

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RULES AND ORDERS

6.0 Illness

- 6.1 A member of staff who is prevented by illness from attending at his/her post shall notify the Head of Department or his/her designate or a Senior Officer of the HR Division within half (1/2) hour of the scheduled commencement time on the first day of absence by telephone, facsimile, letter or any other acceptable form of communication.
- 6.2 In respect of absences not exceeding three days, the employee should complete the relevant leave form immediately on return. Illnesses in excess of three days require a doctor's certificate. (See Sick Leave regulations - D.2).

7.0 Infectious Diseases

- 7.1 A staff member who has contracted, or has been exposed to an infectious disease, such as measles or chicken pox, shall report the facts forthwith to his/her Head of Department and may be required to cease attendance at his/her post until a Medical Officer considers it advisable for him/her to resume.
- 7.2 The Bank reserves the right to refer such an employee to its own Medical Officer for the purpose of obtaining advice on whether or not the employee is in a position to resume regular duties.

8.0 Public Utterances (Secrecy)

- 8.1 On the first day of employment and on the first working day of each calendar year thereafter, all employees are required to sign the Bank's Declaration of Allegiance and Secrecy form.
- 8.2 A member of staff, whether on duty or on leave, should not allow himself/herself to be interviewed or questioned on the Bank's policy or matters affecting the Government, commercial banks or other institutions supervised or regulated by the Bank, or other persons having dealings with the Bank. He/she may not take part in any public discussion of such matters without the prior approval of the Governor.
- 8.3 A member of staff shall not seek to profit financially or otherwise, by making use of information acquired directly or indirectly in the course of his/her duties.
- 8.4 A member of staff shall not, without giving prior notification to the Governor, give evidence concerning the Bank's business in a Court of Law. Neither should the employee make available to the media or to any person, any information, documents or papers which may come into his/her possession in an official capacity, or make private copies of such documents or papers.

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RULES AND ORDERS

9.0 Prohibition from Other Employment or Duties

- 9.1 A member of staff shall not occupy any other office or position of employment, whether remunerated or not, without the specific permission of the Governor.

10.0 Disclosure of Personal Interest - Conflict of Interest

- 10.1 If in the course of duty, a member of staff is called upon to deal with any matter in which he/she has or may have a personal interest, such interest shall be immediately disclosed to the Head of the employee's department, or, where the issue involves the Department Head, to the Governor.

11.0 Alteration and Falsification of Records

- 11.1 No unauthorised erasures and alterations are to be made in any of the Bank's books or records.
- 11.2 All internal erasures and alterations are to receive authorization from the immediate supervisor.
- 11.3 No falsification is to be made to the Bank's records.

12.0 Reporting Fraud

- 12.1 Each employee has a duty to report to the Head of his/her Department or to the Governor, any dishonest practices on the part of a colleague, which may come to his/her knowledge. (See Fraud Policy)

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RULES AND ORDERS

13.0 Gratuities or Gifts from the Public

- 13.1 A member of staff is prohibited from accepting either for himself/herself or a family member, any fee, gift, gratuity or consideration whatsoever, in connection with a service rendered in the employee's official capacity.

14.0 Personal Financial Embarrassment

- 14.1 If a member of staff is unable to meet his/her financial obligations, this information should be communicated by the staff member to his/her Head of Department, which if on investigation, it is established that the employee has been careless or negligent in the handling of his/her personal affairs, action will be taken by the Bank which may include suspension or dismissal.

15.0 External Loan Transactions

- 15.1 Where necessary, a member of staff shall conduct commercial loan transactions only with supervised and regulated institutions.
- 15.2 When in doubt as to the nature of the institution, the employee should consult with the Head of Department and/or the relevant supervisory or regulatory authority before committing himself/herself.
- 15.3 If a staff member obtains a loan from an external financial institution that would result in his/her take-home pay falling below the required 40%, the staff member should inform his/her Head of Department.
- 15.4 Infringement of these rules may lead to dismissal.

16.0 Misuse of the Bank's Time

- 16.1 If a member of staff is found engaged in any activity during business hours which results in misuse of the Bank's time or equipment, the staff member may be liable for disciplinary action.
- 16.2 Gambling or gaming activities on the Bank's premises are prohibited.

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RULES AND ORDERS

17.0 Eating of Meals in Offices

- 17.1 Food is not allowed in the Bank except in designated areas, with permission of the Division Chief.
- 17.2 Items of food obtained from the dining facility or brought from outside must be eaten in either the dining facility, meeting rooms designated for luncheons, or in the Clinic, on request by the Bank's nurse.

18.0 Presence of Children in the Bank

- 18.1 Employees are not allowed to bring children to the Bank during working hours, except under exceptional circumstances, and with special permission from the Division Chief.
- 18.2 In such circumstances, the Protective Services Department should be informed of the child's presence.
- 18.3 The employee is expected to provide strict supervision of the child, and to ensure that the normal professional working environment is maintained.

19.0 Buying and Selling on the Bank's Premises

- 19.1 The buying and selling of goods among members of staff on the Bank's premises is not permitted.
- 19.2 The sorting, distribution and conveyance of goods bought from outsiders by members of staff is not permitted, and may lead to disciplinary action.

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STAFF RECRUITMENT

1.0 Policy Overview

The ability of the Bank to achieve its mission is dependent on the extent to which it can attract and retain qualified employees at all levels. The Bank will recruit the best candidate whether internally or externally.

2.0 Recruitment Procedures

The following steps are followed in effecting the recruitment of staff:

- 2.1 When a position becomes vacant either through a staff movement or the establishment of a new post, a hiring decision is made by the Head of the Division/Department, in consultation with the HR Division.
- 2.2 The level of the position is determined on the basis of a review of the job description and evaluation, where necessary.
- 2.3 Notice of the vacancy will be posted internally and/or externally as is necessary.
- 2.4 All applications received are processed by the Staffing and Performance Management Department and candidates are short listed on the basis of qualification, experience and general suitability for the position.
- 2.5 Interviews for external candidates are conducted as follows:
 - Levels 1 – 8: interview conducted by Assistant Director and Head of Staffing and Performance Management;
 - Levels 9 – 18: interviews conducted by selected panel.

For interviews for internal candidates - see Promotions Policy in Section B4.
- 2.6 A selection is made on the basis of agreed selection criteria. A recommendation for approval is recorded and a submission made to the Management Committee/Committee of Administration for consideration and approval for jobs in Levels 9 – 18. Appointments to positions in Levels 1 – 8 are approved by the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration, in consultation with the Division of the area to which the candidate is to be assigned.
- 2.7 On acceptance of the job offer, security, reference checks and medical examination are conducted for the successful candidate and instructions are given regarding pre-employment requirements. Subject to satisfactory completion of security, medical and reference checks, an employment letter is issued outlining working conditions, benefits, salary and other relevant information.

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STAFF RECRUITMENT

3.0 Probation

- 3.1 No wage increase shall be granted during the probationary period except those as a result of general salary increases.
- 3.2 During the probationary period an assessment of the employee will be conducted to determine the suitability for permanent employment.
- 3.3 Recommendations for confirmation to permanent staff are made to the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration for approval.

The Board of Directors is notified of staff appointments at the Division Chief level and above.

4.0 Exceptions in Recruitment Policy

- 4.1 Subject to its general staff recruitment policy, the Bank does not exercise discriminatory policies in relation to the recruitment for employment of persons on the basis of age, colour, race and religion, except where such persons are found to have been convicted or suspected of an offence involving dishonesty, fraud, or an offence, which, in the Bank's discretion, it considers to be of such a serious nature as to preclude an applicant for recruitment.
- 4.2 The Bank is however cognizant of the need to secure effective co-operation between workers and employers, to ensure the efficiency of its undertakings and to prevent unfair labour practices because of nepotistic behaviour between and among employees, officers and agents.
- 4.3 In order to eliminate or at least minimize both the appearance of and the potential for nepotism, the Bank shall engage in a policy that limits and or prevents the recruitment of near relations of employees of the Bank.

Definition of Near Relations

- 4.4 For the purposes of this policy, the term near relations means – children (including adoptive children), spouses (married or unmarried), siblings and parents (including adoptive parents and siblings). In recruiting for a particular position, the Bank may exercise discretion to extend the categories of near relations where strict adherence to the above definition may be deemed inappropriate for the organisation.
- 4.5 In circumstances where a marriage occurs while persons are in the employment of the Bank, steps may be taken in the sole discretion of the Bank to have one of the parties reassigned to another work area within the Bank.

AUTHORIZED BY	
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PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL POLICY

Revised June 2020

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank's **Performance Appraisal** system is the principal mechanism for measuring employee performance, analysing developmental needs and providing essential feedback. The Performance Appraisal System applies to all members of staff.

2.0 Appraisal Procedures

- 2.1 All employees are set measurable quantifiable objectives and/or competencies at the beginning of the assessment period.
- 2.2 Employees are assessed annually (January - December) on the basis of their performance.
- 2.3 Employees receive feedback on an ongoing basis.
- 2.4 At the end of the assessment period, a formal appraisal of the employee's performance is conducted. Points are awarded based on an evaluation of the performance against the targets and the attainment of specific pre-determined competencies.
- 2.5 A development plan is agreed on and completed for each employee.
- 2.6 A formal record is made of the assessment, verified by the Heads of Department and Division and forwarded to the Human Resource Division (HRD).
- 2.7 Salary increments for permanent employees are awarded on the basis of scores earned in the assessment exercise. The minimum score for awarding an increment is 6500 points. The minimum score for awarding 2 increments (double increment) is 7500 points, and for awarding 3 increments (triple increment) is 8500 points.
- 2.8 The process for completing the Performance Appraisal is outlined in Section 4.0 of the Performance Appraisal Guide.
- 2.9 Where the employee is dissatisfied with the outcome of the performance appraisal, a formal appeal may be made through the Divisional Management to the HRD in keeping with the provisions in the Performance Appraisal Guide (Section 5 – Appeals). This appeal should be made within two weeks of the submission of the appraisal form (after the appraisal interview) to the employee for final comments and sign off.
- 2.10 Where the appeal is not made to the HRD within the two-week period, the score as determined by the supervisor will be the final score.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	15 JUNE 2020

PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL POLICY

3.0 Special Provisions

Approved May 2, 2017

- 3.1 Performance appraisals are to be completed at the end of each period of assignment in which the staff member duties and responsibilities changed, to include acting appointments and job rotations.
- 3.2 Performance appraisals are to be completed for employees prior to exit of the Bank for reason of retirement or resignation.
- 3.3 Departmental Heads are assigned the responsibility for ensuring the completion of the appraisal within one week of the end of special assignments and prior to the exit of employees from the Bank. The HRD will monitor and report on implementation of the policy provisions.
- 3.4 Pro-rated compensation will be granted to employees who exit the Bank for reason of retirement and resignation and who meet the requirements for the payment of increments as outlined in the policy.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	15 JUNE 2020

ACTING APPOINTMENTS AND COMPENSATION FOR NEW OR ADDITIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

Revised July 2020

1.0 Policy Overview

- 1.1. From time to time, employees are required to act in established positions which are above their substantive level of appointment.
- 1.2. Employees may also be required to undertake responsibilities at a higher level in roles which are not established positions. These circumstances occur when:
 - a) New mandates have been assigned to the Division/Department but approval has not yet been granted for the role to be added to the establishment;
 - b) Duties and responsibilities are being undertaken as an interim measure as the Division/Department undergoes organizational review/structural change;
 - c) Officers are assigned to a project with responsibilities/accountabilities at a higher level.
- 1.3. There may also be instances in which staff members are not relieved of their normal duties but are required to undertake additional responsibilities which are outside the scope of their substantive jobs.
- 1.4. In all of the circumstances detailed in 1.1, 1.2, and 1.3, the policy of the Bank is to compensate the employee commensurate with the increased responsibilities being undertaken.

2.0 Criteria for Acting Appointments

- 2.1 An appointment to act in an established position must be for a period of at least twenty (20) continuous working days.
- 2.2 The employee must possess the competencies commensurate with the job in accordance with the Bank's Competency Framework and must be deemed capable of performing in the higher position in the absence of the incumbent as determined by the Divisional Management in consultation with the Human Resources Division.

3.0 Criteria for New or Additional Responsibilities

- 3.1 An employee shall be entitled to be paid compensation for additional duties, where the employee is not relieved of his/her substantive duties but is required to:
 - a) Perform additional duties for a minimum of twenty (20) working days, or
 - b) Contribute to the execution or implementation of a project not relating to or typically assigned to his/her job function.
- 3.2 The employee must possess the competencies commensurate with the job in accordance with the Bank's Competency Framework and must be deemed capable of carrying out the additional responsibilities as determined by the Divisional Management in consultation with the Human Resources Division.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	06 JULY 2020

ACTING APPOINTMENTS AND COMPENSATION FOR NEW OR ADDITIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

4.0 Responsibility for Roles at Lower Levels

- 4.1 Employees who oversee roles at lower levels will not be eligible for compensation if they are required to undertake duties assigned to these roles. However, if the employee has no oversight responsibility for the post at the lower level, the officer will be compensated in accordance with the rules set out in 3.0.

5.0 Administrative Guidelines

Acting Appointments

- 5.1 Where an employee is appointed to act at a higher level for a continuous period of twenty (20) working days and more, the employee shall be entitled to be paid an acting allowance in addition to his/her substantive salary.
- 5.2 The acting allowance is to be calculated on the basis of either:
- a) the difference between the officer's substantive salary and the minimum of the scale of the higher post or
 - b) the equivalent of three (3) increments in the higher salary scale, whichever is greater.
- 5.3 In cases where the officer's salary is above the minimum of the scale of the higher post, the acting allowance will be calculated based on an equivalent salary step in the higher post plus three (3) increments.

Compensation for New/Additional Responsibilities

- 5.4 Subject to 5.5, the Additional Duties Allowance will be calculated based on a level determined by the Bank's Job Evaluation process and paid to the employee in accordance with the pay cycle for the number of days assigned additional duties as per 3.1 above.
- 5.5 For duties associated with a project, where the employee retains responsibility for his/her substantive role, the following applies:
- 5.5.1 Payment will be made on the basis of satisfactory completion of deliverables which may be on a monthly, quarterly, semi-annual or annual basis as determined by the Project Manager.
 - 5.5.2 Payment will be made for the period the officer is assigned to the project and will be calculated based on the attainment of scores consistent with the award of performance increments on the employee's substantive salary for the period.
 - 5.5.3 For projects which are intermittent/ad hoc in nature, payments will be calculated in keeping with 5.5.2 above and will be pro-rated based on the percentage of time spent to complete the project. In these instances, deliverables must be clearly defined by the Project Manager and endorsed by the HRD.

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DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	06 JULY 2020

ACTING APPOINTMENTS AND COMPENSATION FOR NEW OR ADDITIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

5.0 Administrative Guidelines Cont'd

- 5.6 Where the employee is reassigned fully to a project, the duties associated with the project will be assessed and the employee compensated to reflect the responsibilities undertaken, provided that the employee shall in no case, receive less than the salary associated with his or her substantive position.
- 5.7 It is expected that the employee and Project Manager would have established a Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic and Time-bound (SMART) objective(s) associated with the project.
- 5.8 Employees who qualify for the payment of overtime, and are required to carry additional duties relating to posts at lower levels, are not eligible for this allowance.
- 5.9 The assignment of responsibilities for two substantive jobs should not be for more than a period exceeding six months provided that, in instances where a longer period is required, which should be in exceptional circumstances, the recommendation must be accompanied by the appropriate justification endorsed by the relevant Deputy Governor and approved by the Management Committee. In such instances, compensation should be calculated at a minimum of four (4) increments at the higher of the two rates where applicable.

Access to Benefits

- 5.10 In instances where officers are acting or are being compensated for additional responsibilities at higher levels, for periods in excess of a year, the officers should be granted access to all benefits at that higher level. It is to be noted that there may be instances where the initial assignment may be for a shorter period, but cumulatively extends beyond a year. In these instances, the officer should be paid the benefits retroactive to the start date.
- 5.11 In relation to accessing loans (at higher salary levels) with long term repayment periods, the loan request must be endorsed in writing by the Divisional Management and by the HRD taking into consideration the likely tenure of the individual in the higher role.

Performance Increments

- 5.12 In instances where an officer is on an acting assignment or being compensated for new or additional duties, for periods in excess of a year, and appraised at the higher level, performance increments, where applicable, should be awarded at the level of the acting role or the level being compensated, as the case may be.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	06 JULY 2020

ACTING APPOINTMENTS AND COMPENSATION FOR NEW OR ADDITIONAL RESPONSIBILITIES

6.0 Procedures for Approval

- 6.1 All requests for acting appointments or compensation for new/additional responsibilities must be recommended by the Division Chief, Deputy Division Chief or Senior Director, endorsed by the relevant Deputy Governor and approved by the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Human Resources.
- 6.2 Acting in an established position in excess of six months is not allowed. However, in exceptional circumstances, approval may be given by the Committee of Administration for positions up to Level 18 and Management Committee for positions Level 19-21. In instances where the acting period is greater than six months, consideration will be given to rotating officers appointed to act as a part of the developmental strategy.

7.0 Absence During Acting Appointment or While Compensated for New/Additional Responsibilities

- 7.1 Persons entitled to Day Release and whose Day Release falls within the qualifying period of twenty consecutive working days, will still be eligible to receive acting or new/additional responsibilities emoluments. In this circumstance, the Day Release is treated as a regular working day.
- 7.2 The entitlement to these emoluments during the qualifying period will not be lost if the appointee is absent from work for reasons of illness or emergency, providing the absence does not exceed three working days in aggregate.
- 7.3 The acting appointment will be suspended if any leave in excess of twenty (20) days is taken after the period of acting appointment begins with the suspension commencing on the effective date of the leave.
- 7.4 In instances where the additional responsibilities within the scope of this policy are assigned on an ongoing basis, the accountability for the role continues and therefore suspension of payment for leave of absence in excess of twenty (20) days should not apply given the nature of the assignment which could be prolonged for reasons such as pending organizational review and restructuring.
- 7.5 However, in instances where the assignment of the additional or new responsibilities will be for periods less than six months then the provisions of the acting policy with respect to suspension of compensation at the higher level will apply.

8.0 Persons Acting in Positions that are Subsequently Upgraded

- 8.1 A person acting in a position that has been upgraded after the acting period commences, will continue to act and receive compensation at the level attached to the upgraded position.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	06 JULY 2020

INTERNAL PROMOTION

Revised May 2021

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the objective of the Bank to build and retain a competent, professional and engaged workforce in pursuit of the delivery of the Bank's mandate. One of the means of achieving this is through internal promotion. In addition to providing a pool of qualified employees, a system of internal promotions provides career growth and development opportunities for competent and high-performing employees. The Bank's policy, therefore, is to allow competent employees access to interviews for promotion.

2.0 Scope - Entitlement

2.1 All employees of the Bank, who are eligible, will be considered for promotion by the Bank's Management.

Promotion within the Bank is defined as the upward movement of a staff member from a lower level to a higher level. Where a position is broad-banded, the movement from the lower to higher level within the band is not deemed as promotion but as an upgrade.

2.2 Eligibility criteria for promotion are:

- Possession of the requisite academic and/or professional qualification for the higher post.
- Consistently good performance record
- Possession of the requisite technical skills and other key competencies applicable to the post to which promotion is sought.
- Relevant experience, training and exposure necessary to function effectively in the post.

The Human Resources Division (HRD) in consultation with the applicant's divisional management will determine suitability for promotion to the level to which the staff member is being considered.

3.0 Administrative Arrangements

3.1 The HR Division will advertise the job using the standard staff communication channels such as the INTRANET and notice boards, and invite applications. In instances where external candidates will be considered for interviews, as determined by the relevant division in consultation with HR, jobs will also be advertised in the print and social media.

3.2 The HR Division is responsible for screening candidates, advising applicants as to whether or not they have been short-listed and scheduling interviews. Officers of the relevant department will be consulted in the shortlisting of candidates. In order to ensure a high degree of job fit, applicants may be required to undertake a written assessment, which may include psychometric assessments.

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DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	26 MAY 2021

INTERNAL PROMOTION

3.0 Administrative Arrangements Cont'd

- 3.3 Interviews will not be required in circumstances where there is a single internal applicant who has been assessed as being capable of doing the job by the HR Division in consultation with the Management of the relevant Division.
- 3.4 Candidates who have not been selected for an interview for jobs at level 21 and below, and who are of the view that special circumstances warrant their inclusion, may appeal to the Deputy Governor under which the job falls within three working days after being so advised. In cases where that Deputy Governor was involved in the short-listing process the candidate should instead make their appeal to the Senior Deputy Governor.
- 3.5 Candidates will be interviewed by a panel selected by the HR Division. Panellists will use a grading sheet to quantify their assessment of the candidates.
- 3.6 Results of interviews, Levels 10 to 18, inclusive, are to be submitted to the Committee of Administration (COA) within five working days of the final interview. The COA approves appointments for staff at levels 10 – 14 and endorses for Management Committee (MC) approval appointments for staff at levels 15 – 18. In the case of appointments of staff at levels 10 – 14, COA will advise the HR Division of its decision and also provide information to MC. For appointments of staff at levels 15 – 18 these are subject to approval of MC which will advise the HR Division of its decision.
- 3.7 For appointment of staff at levels 19-20 these are submitted directly to MC for approval and advice of its decision to HR Division.
- 3.8 For all levels up to level 20, both successful and unsuccessful candidates, are to be advised by the HR Division of the outcome.

4.0 Appointments

- 4.1 Appointments to positions at Levels 15 - 20 are made on the basis of a panel interview comprising at least two (2) Deputy Governors inclusive of the Deputy Governor with portfolio responsibility for the Human Resources Division and at least one Division Chief inclusive of the Division Chief under which the job falls.
- 4.2 Appointments to positions at Levels 13 – 14 are made on the basis of a panel interview involving a minimum of two (2) Division Chiefs to include the Division Chief with portfolio responsibility for Human Resources and the Division under which the job falls. This should also include at least one other panellist at the minimum level of Head of Department (Level 18).
- 4.3 Appointments to positions at Levels 10 – 12 are made on the basis of a panel interview comprising one representative from the Division in which the job exists, one of which should be at the level of Senior Director or Director, one representative from the HR Division, an independent Director or Assistant Director and one union representative at the appropriate level.
- 4.4 A panel interview may be required for appointments to positions below Level 10. Where these interviews are conducted, the panel will comprise two representatives of HRD to include the Head of Staffing and should also comprise a Director from the requesting Department.

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INTERNAL PROMOTION

4.0 Appointments Cont'd

Promotions up to Level 4 are approved by Division Chief, Human Resources and promotions 5 to 9 are approved by the Deputy Governor with portfolio responsibility for the HRD.

- 4.5 Notwithstanding the above, management at decision levels outlined in 3.6 and 3.7 above, may make direct appointments without going through the interview process to positions in instances where staff have been assigned to carry out new/interim roles for periods of more than one year if such roles are approved on the establishment, provided they perform satisfactorily. Such appointments may also be made in instances where staff are acting for periods of more than one year in positions which eventually become vacant.
- 4.6 Promotion into a new grade will result in an increase in an employee's salary, equivalent to the addition to his/her current salary of no less than two (2) increments of the level into which the officer is being promoted. Increases above this may be effected by management decision.

5.0 Appointment of Senior Management Staff

The administrative arrangement outlined at 3.1 to 4.6 will apply to all levels of staff except as indicated below.

- 5.1 Appointment of the Governor is made by the Governor General in Council, i.e., Governor General on the advice of Cabinet, in accordance with the Bank of Jamaica Act. Advice of such appointment will be by the Minister.
- 5.2 Appointment of the Senior Deputy Governor is made by the Governor General in Council upon the recommendation of the Board of the Bank in keeping with provisions in the Bank of Jamaica Act. Advice is made by the Minister.
- 5.3 Appointments of Deputy Governors are made by the Board of the Bank on the recommendation of the Governor in keeping with provisions in the Bank of Jamaica Act. Advice to the successful appointee is made by the Governor.
- 5.4 Appointments to positions at Level 21 and above, excluding staff at 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3, are made by the Board on a recommendation from the Management Committee endorsed by the HRD Committee of the Board of Directors.

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SUCCESSION MANAGEMENT

Revised December 2015

1.0 Policy Overview

- 1.1 The Succession Management Policy of the Bank of Jamaica is outlined in this document. The purpose of the Policy is to guide the identification and mitigation of risk to the Bank resulting from potential disruption or loss of effectiveness as a consequence of critical positions becoming vacant. This is in recognition of the fact that the efficiency and effectiveness of the Bank could be seriously compromised as a result of separation of key employees from positions at risk, and extended delays in resourcing those positions.
- 1.2 A position is considered to be at risk if:
 - i. The Bank is at risk of losing critical knowledge and skills because it is occupied by an incumbent who is within 5 to 7 years of the normal age of retirement;
 - and/or**
 - ii. The position requires specialized or unique technical expertise (skill sets) which would not be available to the Bank in the event of the separation of the incumbent;
 - and**
 - iii. A talent pool of three or more officers who possess skills and competencies required for the position is not immediately available to the Bank.
- 1.3 This policy does not exclude employees who have not been selected for participation in the Succession Management Programme (SMP). This is on the basis that all promotions, including promotion of participants in the SMP, will be subject to the provisions of the Bank's Promotions Policy including the Guideline for Exceptional Treatment under the Promotions Policy.
- 1.4 In order to ameliorate the exposure related to positions at risk the specific policy provisions that are detailed in the following sections will be applied:
 - i. Methodology, Criteria and Selection of Candidates;
 - ii. Training and Development; and
 - iii. Roles and Responsibilities.

2.0 Methodology, Criteria and Selection of Candidates

- 2.1 The SMP involves a continuous assessment of leadership competencies and technical skills required by the Bank to ensure the timely selection and preparation of qualified and competent employees to deliver the Bank's mission and goals.
- 2.2 The SMP is open to all members of staff who meet the criteria. There are two methods by which candidates are incorporated into the Programme:

Selection from a group of potential candidates identified by:

- a. Divisional management based on the criteria as outlined in this policy as well as the identified officer's demonstration of the required competencies for the relevant position(s) at risk.
- b. Members of staff who have registered an interest to participate in the SMP based on meeting the requisite competencies and other criteria as stated in this policy.

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SUCCESSION MANAGEMENT

2.0 Methodology, Criteria and Selection of Candidates Cont'd

- 2.3 Candidates for SMP for each position at risk will be selected with reference to the following criteria:
- i. Relevant academic qualification;
 - ii. Appropriate knowledge of the relevant area(s) of the Bank's operations or demonstrated potential to perform in the relevant area(s);
 - iii. Attainment of at least double increment performance appraisal scores in the last two (2) years;
 - iv. Strong communication skills;
 - v. Proven leadership skills or demonstrated strong leadership potential, where relevant;
 - vi. Recommendation from the Division Chief and the Deputy Governor of the Division to which the officer is assigned.
- 2.4 Eligible candidates will be selected for inclusion in the SMP with reference to the selection process outlined below:
- i. Preferably, at least three candidates from across the Bank will be selected for participation in the SMP for each targeted position.
 - ii. An individual may be selected for inclusion in the SMP as a candidate for more than one position.
 - iii. Candidates may be identified from the external recruitment and selection process.
 - iv. Candidates may be identified for succession into positions which are more than two levels above their substantive position. This is on the understanding that all promotions, including promotion of participants in the SMP, will be subject to the provisions of the Bank's Promotions Policy including the Guideline for Exceptional Treatment under the Promotions Policy.
 - v. Candidates identified may be required to undergo objective assessment interventions to determine suitability.

3.0 Training and Development

- 3.1 The Bank will develop and administer Individual Training and Development Plans (ITDP) for each participant in the SMP. The competencies to be acquired, the development activities to be pursued, the timeframe for achievement and the expected results will be outlined in the ITDP.
- 3.2 For each competency gap identified, various interventions will be engaged inclusive of:
- i. Formal leadership development programmes;
 - ii. On-the-job training provided for more experienced employees;
 - iii. Attachments at various institutions;
 - iv. Attendance at training programmes and/or enrollment in online programmes;
 - v. Attendance at conferences and seminars;
 - vi. Job rotation to broaden skills;
 - vii. Mentoring through the assignment of a member of the senior staff, or other suitably qualified individuals, to provide guidance, advice and assistance to the potential successor.

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SUCCESSION MANAGEMENT

3.0 Training and Development Cont'd

- 3.3 Whilst the Bank commits to assisting individuals to qualify for higher levels of responsibility, the individuals must continue to perform well in their current jobs while preparing to meet the challenges at higher levels.

4.0. Roles and Responsibilities

The responsibilities for oversight and administration of the SMP will be undertaken by the Succession Planning Committee (SPC) and the Human Resources Division as outlined in the following subsections.

4.1 **The Succession Planning Committee** is responsible for:

- i. Reviewing the assessment of areas of risk associated with critical positions across the Bank to ensure that appropriate succession management strategies are developed and maintained;
 - ii. Reviewing recommendations of the Human Resources Division with regard to potential successors and the talent management programmes designed for the identified successors;
 - iii. Monitoring the progress of succession plans and reporting to the Bank's Senior Management on the progress of these plans.
 - iv. Ensuring that a comprehensive review of the SMP is conducted on an annual basis.
- 4.1.1. The SPC will be comprised of representatives from each division and headed by the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration and will provide cross divisional input for the succession planning process through policy review as well as review of periodic reports.
- 4.1.2. Divisional representatives on the SPC are required to provide input in the overall SMP by:
- i. Assisting with the timely identification of critical positions within the divisions;
 - ii. Assisting with the identification of candidates for inclusion in the SMP.
- 4.1.3. Reports of the deliberations of the SPC will be submitted to the Bank's senior management advising on the areas of risk, the selection of candidate and development plans.

4.2 **The Human Resources Division** is responsible for:

- i. Identifying, in collaboration with Deputy Governors/Division Chiefs, the critical positions at risk and forecasting vacancies.
- ii. Identifying, in collaboration with Deputy Governors/Division Chiefs, potential candidates to be included in the SMP for approval by the Bank's senior management;
- iii. Coordinating the development of succession plans and reviewing the progress of potential successors as they work towards completion of the ITDP.
- iv. Recommending and monitoring the progress in implementing the recommendations for resourcing the target positions through the following process:

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SUCCESSION MANAGEMENT

4.0. Roles and Responsibilities Cont'd

- a. Determining areas of risk in the Bank;
 - b. Identifying positions at risk;
 - c. Determining required skills and competencies;
 - d. Identifying and establishing the required talent pool;
 - e. Identifying development needs;
 - f. Formulating Individual Development Plans;
 - g. Developing performance goals;
 - h. Providing development opportunities;
 - i. Training, coaching and nurturing talent pool; and
 - j. Conducting an annual review of the process
- v. On an annual basis, reviewing and reporting on the succession planning needs of the Bank and recommending strategies for adequately addressing areas of exposure.

5 .0 Communication of the Succession Management Programme

- 5.1 Important to the succession of the SMP is the implementation of an effective communication strategy. All levels of staff are informed of the SMP through the following channels:
- i. The Management of the Human Resources Division holds discussions with Divisional Heads on the policy.
 - ii. Divisional Heads discuss with their staff the policy guiding the Bank's SMP.
 - iii. The publication of succession management tools such as the Risk Assessment Matrix and the Competency and Skills Matrix on the Bank's Intranet.

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SECONDMENT OF STAFF FROM THE BANK

1.0 Policy Overview

From time to time, the Bank, in response to requests from other organisations, may grant staff secondment to another organisation. The Bank may consider such requests in circumstances where the secondment will:

- 1.1 Contribute to the professional growth and development of the individual in an area relevant to the Bank's mandate.
- 1.2 Provide support to management in the wider public sector, including international public service.

2.0 Terms and Conditions of Secondment

- 2.1 The maximum period of secondment is two years. However, the Bank may consider an extension of this period in the appropriate circumstances.
- 2.2 The seconded staff will be paid by the organization to which he/she has been seconded.
- 2.3 The seconded employee should not suffer any loss of compensation (e.g. salary) as a result of the secondment.
- 2.4 Seconded staff will retain benefits under the Bank's pension and insurance schemes (or any other deferred compensation to which there is an entitlement as an employee of the Bank).
- 2.5 The organization to which the person is seconded will reimburse the Bank for its contribution to the Insurance, Health and Pension Schemes.
- 2.6 At the termination of the period of secondment, the employee shall return to his/her substantive post.

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REDUNDANCY

1.0 Policy Overview

A redundancy occurs when there is an involuntary loss of employment as a result of a change in the operations and structure of the organization. The policy of the Bank is to compensate the employee by making a redundancy payment in accordance with national law or as supplemented by negotiated agreement. (See BOJ Redundancy Provisions – Revised 1998).

2.0 Entitlement

- 2.1 To qualify for redundancy, an employee must have completed 104 weeks (two years) of continuous employment.

3.0 Redundancy provisions

- 3.1 Employees who complete continuous years of service as indicated below will receive redundancy payments as follows:

<u>Years of Service</u>	<u>Payment for Each Year of Service</u>
2 - 5	Two (2) weeks
Over 5 - 10	Three (3) weeks
Over 10 - 20	Four (4) weeks
Over 20	Six (6) weeks

4.0 Qualification for Notice

Employees with continuous years of service as detailed below are entitled to notice of redundancy as follows:

<u>Years of Service</u>	<u>Notice Period/Payment in Lieu of Notice</u>
Under 10	Four (4) weeks notice or four (4) weeks pay, in lieu of notice.
10 but less than 15	Six (6) weeks notice or six (6) weeks pay, in lieu of notice.
15 but less than 20	Eight (8) weeks notice or eight (8) weeks pay, in lieu of notice.
20 years and over	Twelve (12) weeks notice or twelve (12) weeks pay, in lieu of notice.

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WORK FROM HOME

1.0 Purpose

The Work From Home (WFH) Policy provides a framework and clear guidelines within which the Bank can effectively implement revised work arrangements which will allow staff to work from home in certain circumstances. It will guide the employer/employee relationship in the execution of the work arrangements.

2.0 Scope

This Policy applies to all members of staff whose duties and responsibilities can be effectively performed from Home whether on a temporary or permanent basis.

3.0 Policy Objectives

The objectives of the Work From Home Arrangements are to:

1. Provide the organization and employees with flexibility in working arrangements;
2. Allow a higher degree of work-life balance for employees;
3. Provide the organization with a wider talent pool;
4. Aid in the management of onsite facilities to include, *inter alia*, office space and furniture.

4.0 Policy Statement

The Bank will consider and approve requests/ applications from staff to work from home for pre-determined and agreed periods. The approval for staff to perform specific work obligations during agreed work hours from home is entirely at the discretion of the Bank.

5.0 Eligibility Requirements

- 5.1 Staff must meet the following pre-eligibility requirements to be considered for the Work from Home Policy:
 - (a) Job functions or project can efficiently and effectively be carried out off site;
 - (b) Staff member should be employed at the Bank for at least one (1) year. Access to the WFH programme for team members employed less than one year may be given in special circumstances.
 - (c) Staff member should have attained an appraisal score of at least 6500 on their last end of year performance appraisal report;
 - (d) Staff member should have suitable arrangements at home to accommodate working from home; and
 - (e) Staff member should demonstrate the ability to work independently.
- 5.2 Requirements (b) and (c) may be temporarily waived in the event of illness, Act of God or a public health emergency.

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5.0 Eligibility Requirements Cont'd

- 5.3 WFH will **not** normally be approved for the following staff:
- (a) All staff during their first year in a new position (new hire).
 - (b) Those employees working under a Performance Improvement Plan; or
 - (c) Employees who were subject to disciplinary action in the last two (2) years.
- 5.4 In order to determine eligibility an Employee Assessment form must be completed by the Supervisor and Head of Department for the Recommendation of the Division Chief. This should thereafter be submitted to the Human Resources Division for approval (**See Appendix 3**).

6.0 Job Suitability

- 6.1 Some jobs by design lend themselves to remote working as most activities and deliverables can be accomplished partially or wholly off site.
- 6.2 Some jobs are not suited for WFH because they require an in-person presence at the office. These include positions requiring:
- (a) Face-to-face personal contact.
 - (b) Hands on operation of equipment, vehicles or other onsite assets.
 - (c) Direct handling of secure materials that cannot be handled remotely.
 - (d) Activities dependent on a physical presence.
- 6.3 Employees, Head of Departments and Division Chiefs are required to complete and submit the WFH Job Assessment Form (**Appendix 2**) for consideration and approval by the Human Resources Division.

7.0 Considerations for Approval of Work- From-Home Request

The Bank is responsible for determining whether an employee can work from home and whether the nature of the function performed by the employee allows for work from home. The following are areas that will be considered in the approval for employees to work from home.

- 7.1 **The Employee should:**
- (a) Possess the competence and ability to perform assigned duties without close supervision, in the judgement of the Head of Department/Division Chief.
 - (b) Be able to effectively deliver outputs consistent with work requirements without distractions.
 - (c) Ensure that the nature of the work can be accomplished through technology and that he/she has the requisite IT equipment to perform his/her duties.
 - (d) Have higher than average self-discipline and self-management skills, particularly time management as assessed by HOD/Division Chief.
- 7.2 **Performance Management**
- Performance standards for employees assigned to work from home are the same as those for on-site employees. Supervisors and supervisees must ensure the following:

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7.0 Considerations for Approval of Work- From-Home Request Cont'd

- (a) SMART Objectives are established and agreed by both parties prior to commencing the WFH arrangement;
- (b) Agreed arrangements for the immediate Line Manager/Supervisor and the team member to review progress jointly at appropriate intervals;
- (c) A clear understanding of how any development/training needs will be met in cases where working from home is likely to occur over an extended period;
- (d) The staff member is provided with the requisite support to reasonably meet the required performance standards.
- (e) Where an employee is working from home for a significant portion of their time, the Managers/Supervisors must ensure that he/she keeps frequent contact with the employee. Importantly also, Managers/Supervisors must ensure that all the requirements of the Performance Management System are met. The term *frequent contact* must be within the normal requirements for the performance of the duties carried out by the team member who is being assigned to work from home.

Disclaimer: An objective consideration of WFH Policy is intended to ensure an equitable process, but does not guarantee similar outcomes among employees due to differences in job roles, job performance and departmental operations. Therefore, some employees will not be able to take advantage of every provision allowed by this policy.

8.0 Procedures/Administrative Guidelines

GENERAL WORK-FROM-HOME REQUIREMENTS

Conditions Under which Working from Home will be considered

Work From Home is a strategy employed by the Bank where feasible and team members **may** be considered to work from home in situations which includes the following:

- (a) Suitability of Jobs for Work From Home
- (b) Medical Reasons
- (c) Natural Disaster (for example, flood, hurricane etc.)
- (d) Public health emergencies, such as a pandemic

8.1 WFH - Office Space

The staff member will be required to arrange on their own accord a suitable space in their home, which will allow for undisturbed work at home. This includes furniture, which would be suitable for long periods of computer work e.g., suitable table and chair that meet the same or similar standards as required within an office environment. The Bank will verify the suitability of these equipment.

8.2 Technological Support and Information Security

- 8.2.1 The Bank shall provide technological devices for the team member to perform adequately while working from home. This includes a laptop and/or monitor, and any other device, save and except for internet connectivity, that will aid communication between the organization and the team member.

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8.0 Procedures/Administrative Guidelines Contd.

- 8.2.2 When working from home, the team member must be aware of the increased risk of a security and confidentiality breach, ensure that all documentation is stored securely and that the company issued laptop/ computer is password protected and turned off when not in use.
- 8.2.3 All IT equipment provided to the team member to support working from home is for the exclusive use of that team member only. Employees should not allow unauthorized persons to use such equipment.
- 8.2.4 The staff member is required to observe and comply with the Bank's Policies and Procedures which are available on the Intranet, and in particular, shall operate within the Bank's IT Security policies and guidelines regarding the use of IT equipment and applications.
- 8.2.5 Any technological challenges must be communicated immediately to the Head of Department/Supervisor. If the issue cannot be resolved via telephone or other communication means, the team member will be required to visit the Bank to have the issue resolved. The Technology team will not visit the team member at their home address to resolve any such issues.
- 8.2.6 All IT concerns should be directed to the Information Technology and Records Management Division adhering to the usual channel of escalation for said queries. Allowing any unauthorized individual or third party to access company information/systems is expressly prohibited and a breach of this obligation is subject to sanctions in accordance with the Bank's Human Resource Policy.
- 8.3 **Telecommunication costs**
The Bank will cover the cost of data charges of up to 50mbps and business-related call charges (made outside of bundled package) upon presentation of bills in the name of the employee; the employee will be required to pay for personal calls.
- 8.4 **Stationery**
Stationery items which the team member will require in order to perform their duties should be ordered via their department and collected by them from the Bank (Nethersole Place).
- 8.5 **Uniform**
Under the WFH arrangements employees may be required to attend work at any time, therefore the current arrangements for female uniforms will continue except that the value of up to (3) sets of uniforms will be monetized and paid to eligible officers given the reduced requirements to be in attendance at the office.

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8.0 Procedures/Administrative Guidelines Cont'd

8.6 Other Terms and Conditions

- a) The team member's current compensation and benefits will be retained.
- b) Representatives of the Bank will, with prior notice, visit the team member's premises to ensure that the infrastructure is adequate. The notice will not be less than three (3) business days.
- c) The Bank **will not** provide air conditioning for the Home Office space nor cover electricity costs.
- d) The staff member must ensure that he/she has in place a reliable, current, and active internet connection.

8.7 Attendance at office

- 8.7.1 An employee who is approved to work from home is required to observe the Bank's Policies and Procedures, including but not limited to the guidelines on Sick Leave. If an employee is unable to work on a scheduled work from home day due to sickness, injury or otherwise, they must follow the Bank's Policy on Sick Leave and report all absence from work in accordance therewith.
- 8.7.2 The employee is required to inform the Head of Department/Supervisor of the date of illness and the expected date of return from illness as if they were normally attending work. If the reason for an employee's pre-authorized work from home agreement was due to illness or disability, then mandated attendance at office meetings will be reviewed on an individual basis.
- 8.7.3 Employees approved for participation in the WFH programme are required to work from the Bank's offices at least once per week unless otherwise determined by the Bank. Despite any pre-authorized work from home arrangement, if an employee is required to attend the Bank for internal/external meetings, office briefings, training, and interviews inter alia, he/she will be given advance notice and is expected to attend.
- 8.7.4 Cost for travelling to main office location for any reason will be at the team member's expense.

8.8 Employee Development

An employee who works from home should be treated no less favourably than those working within an office. Managers/Supervisors must also ensure that the training needs of the team member are fully considered and that they are offered training opportunities in the same manner as those working in an office/or on site.

9.0 Process of Application to Work From Home

- 9.1 An employee may request permission to work from home by making a formal application in writing to the Manager/Supervisor setting out the reasons. The Manager/Supervisor is required to consult with the Human Resources Division in considering the application of the team member. If agreed, the team member will be required to sign an Agreement confirming the terms of this arrangement. This will include an understanding that the Bank may at any time withdraw permission for Work from Home in the event that the employee is not performing within expectation or otherwise at the entire discretion of the Bank without cause. The steps below should be followed in order to commence the process:

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9.0 Process of Application to Work From Home Cont'd

- (a) Team member submits a request to the Head of Department at least one month in advance.
 - (b) The Head of Department must recommend their request considering all elements mentioned herein.
 - (c) The Division Chief with responsibility must endorse the application and submit to HR for the consideration and approval of the Deputy Governor with responsibility for HR or the Division Chief HR.
 - (d) HODs and team members should meet to discuss details and set specific goals, schedules and timelines.
- 9.2 Team members who need to work from home for unforeseen circumstances should make their application to the Manager/Supervisor as soon as possible so that they may consider and approve same.

10.0 Health and Safety

- 10.1 It is acknowledged that the work from home arrangement may be entered into by the Bank based on the employee's request and is primarily aimed at accommodating the employee. It is the responsibility of the employee who it is agreed may work from home to ensure that the premises are suitable for the purposes and to take all reasonable care for their own health and safety and that of other persons who may be affected by the arrangement. Employees are to immediately make the Bank aware of any health and safety issues which may arise or which they reasonably believe could arise from the work from home arrangement. The Bank will not be liable for any injuries or losses to the employee or any other person that may arise in respect of a failure on the part of the employee in this regard and from the work from home arrangement generally unless this is a direct result of the act, neglect or default of the Bank.
- 10.2 Employees shall ensure that there is nothing in any insurance policy with respect to the employee's residence that would prevent work from home and by agreeing to the arrangement guarantee to the employer that there is no such prohibition.
- 10.3 The Bank as part of its general duty to take reasonable care for the safety of employees will undertake initial assessments to ensure that the plant and equipment made available to staff to facilitate working from home are safe and that the general environment in which the staff will operate generally appears to be fit for purpose. The Bank will also hold discussions with the relevant employees to ascertain their safety and health needs which would inform the content of the work from home arrangement. The Bank will also provide information and training about health and safety issues such as ergonomics and hazards etc. Staff members will be required to sign as receiving this information.

11.0 Confidentiality

Members of Staff while working from home will remain subject to all confidentiality clauses contained within their contract of employment or any other policy or guideline in force or as amended from time to time by the Bank. A disclosure of confidential information during the course of employment may be considered by the Bank as gross misconduct, and constitutes grounds for termination of employment in accordance with due process.

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12.0 Appendices

- 12.1 The team member's original Contract of Employment will be retained. However, the terms and conditions of the Work from Home arrangement as set out in the Work from Home Agreement (**Appendix 1**) will form an addendum to the original Contract of Employment.
- 12.2 **Appendix 2** details the Job Assessment Requirements used to determine the eligibility of the job to be part of the Bank's Work from Home arrangement.
- 12.3 **Appendix 3** details the Employee Assessment Form used to determine the eligibility of an employee to be part of the Bank's Work from Home arrangement.
- 12.4 **Appendix 4** details the Equipment Checklist which must be completed prior to commencement of the WFH arrangement.
- 12.5 **Appendix 5** details The WFH Home Assessment Checklist which must be deemed satisfactory prior to the home being approved for WFH Arrangements.

Appendices are located on the Bank's Intranet (Document Centre).

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SALARY ADMINISTRATION

1.0 Policy Overview

In order to achieve its mission and objectives, the Bank must at all times have in its employment a highly competent, professional and dedicated workforce. The Bank's compensation policy is driven by the need to attract, retain and properly reward the best available talent in the market-place within the realm of what it is able to pay. With regard to external equity, the objective of the Bank is to benchmark its remuneration against the market. This market comprises comparable institutions in the Private and Public Sector, other Central Banks and multilateral institutions.

2.0 Job Evaluation

- 2.1 A structured process of Job Evaluation is used in order to maintain internal relativities vis-à-vis the contents of specific job descriptions to determine jobs and to provide a basis for external comparability.
- 2.2 The evaluation is based on the analysis of job requirements, the know-how needed, how the job uses this know-how and the impact of the job on the overall performance of the Bank.
- 2.3 An internal panel, comprised of persons with a sound knowledge of the organization, reviews jobs on an ongoing basis and recommends to the Management Committee/Committee of Administration where the jobs should be positioned in the grading system.

3.0 Job Grades (Levels)

- 3.1 A grading system is maintained based on the weights assigned to jobs. All jobs within the Bank are assigned to a specific grade (Levels 1 – 27). Each level has thirteen incremental steps and demarcates the minimum and the maximum amount that can be paid to the job-holder at each level.
- 3.2 Any proposal for changes at the assigned level must first have the approval of the Governor in consultation with the Management Committee/Committee of Administration.

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SALARY ADMINISTRATION

4.0 Changes to Remuneration

- 4.1 Changes to the salary scale related to the jobs of Governor, Senior Deputy Governor and Deputy Governors (Levels 22-27) are the prerogative of the Minister of Finance.
- 4.2 Changes in salary scales for staff at Levels 17 – 21 are determined through discussions with the Management Committee/Committee of Administration with reference to the relativities vis-à-vis other levels in the Bank and are approved by the Board of Directors.
- 4.3 Changes in salary scale for staff at Levels 1 - 16 are approved by the Board of Directors, after determination through the collective bargaining process with representatives of those groups and representatives of the Bank's management.
- 4.4 At the end of the negotiating process, the salary scales [for Levels 1 – 16] are altered on the basis of the agreement reached and approved by the Ministry of Finance.

5.0 Progression Through Salary Scale

- 5.1 All new members of staff and persons who have been promoted, are placed at the appropriate level and incremental step by the HR Division in consultation with the Division Head.
- 5.2 Further movement in the level may come as a result of incremental adjustment (single or double or triple) based on performance recorded in the Performance Appraisal process.
- 5.3 Movement in the level may also be the result of management decision.

6.0 Payment of Salaries

- 6.1 Salaries are paid monthly in arrears. Normal pay day is the 24th of each month. If the 24th falls on a Saturday, payment is made on the 23rd. If on a Sunday, payment is made on the 25th. Exceptions are January and December, when payment is made before the 24th at management's discretion.
- 6.2 Payment is normally effected by way of a transfer of funds to the employee's internal current account or to an external account with a commercial bank.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

SENIOR STAFF MOTOR VEHICLE ALLOCATION

1.0 Policy Overview

To support its objective of attracting and retaining a cadre of qualified senior staff, the Bank, as part of its overall compensation system, undertakes to provide staff of specified Levels with a fully maintained motorcar. (See Senior Staff Motor Vehicle Policy)

2.0 Eligibility

- 2.1 The **Governor** is assigned a fully maintained motorcar replaceable at three-year intervals.
- 2.2 **Deputy Governors** are each assigned a motor vehicle, replaceable at three-year intervals.
- 2.3 Officers appointed at **Levels 15 to 21** are each assigned a motor vehicle, replaceable at three-year intervals.

3.0 Reference Car

- 3.1 The Bank will periodically establish a reference car for each Level. The reference car will be the standard vehicle assignable to officers within specified Levels.
- 3.2 The Bank will permit officers to select vehicles other than the reference car on condition that:
 - the requesting officer undertakes to purchase the selected vehicle from the Bank at the end of the period of assignment in respect of the particular motor vehicle, or on cessation of employment to the Bank, whichever comes first; and,
 - to finance, from his/her own resources, the difference between the price of the selected vehicle and the price of the reference car.
- 3.3 A newly appointed officer to Level 15 and above, who owns a suitable motor vehicle will be permitted to opt for receiving the full motor vehicle upkeep allowance in lieu of the provision of a motorcar. The motor vehicle must not be more than five (5) years old in order for the officer to be eligible for receipt of the allowance.
- 3.4 An officer may elect to acquire a motor vehicle under the Bank's "Staff Car Loan Facility" as an alternative to being assigned a Bank-owned vehicle.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

SENIOR STAFF MOTOR VEHICLE ALLOCATION

4.0 Maintenance

- 3.1 The Bank will be responsible for the maintenance of the assigned reference car. This responsibility will be delegated to the assignee and the cost financed through the payment of a partial upkeep allowance.
- 4.2 The maintenance allowance payable will be determined annually.

5.0 Authority to Drive

- 5.1 The assignee and any other licensed driver above the age of 21 authorised by the assignee are authorised to drive the vehicle.

6.0 Limitation of Use

- 6.1 The vehicle MUST NOT be used for commercial purposes, racing or any other purpose prohibited under a private motor comprehensive insurance policy.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

TAXI-FARE

1.0 Policy Overview

Payment of a Taxi Fare Allowance evolved out of the need for the provision of safe transportation for all staff members who are required to work from 6:00 p.m. and beyond.

2.0 Eligibility

- 2.1 Staff members in Levels 1 to 12 who are required to work overtime, are eligible for Taxi-fare Allowance, subject to 2.2 below.
- 2.2 The eligibility is confined to staff members who are not provided with a Bank car; or do not receive Travelling Allowance or do not own or drive a motor vehicle whether financed by the Bank or not.

3.0 Administrative Arrangement

- 3.1 Eligible staff members should submit claims, approved by the respective Heads of Department, to the Accounting Services Department, and payment made in accordance with the approved taxi -fares scale.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

MILEAGE ALLOWANCE

1.0 Policy Overview

Payment of a Mileage Allowance evolved out of the need for the Bank to compensate designated officers who own motor vehicles and are required to perform external assignments outside a three-mile radius from the Bank. Members of staff who are provided with Bank vehicles or drive their own vehicles, and are required to work on their day off are also compensated.

2.0 Eligibility

The following staff members are eligible:

- 2.1 A mileage allowance is payable to employees Levels 1 – 12 who are requested to work on weekends, designated rest days and public holidays who drive to the Bank or other location to perform an agreed task.
- 2.2 Mileage is payable to an employee who is specifically requested to use his or her personal vehicle for transportation to the Bank or an off site location.
- 2.3 Mileage is payable from the employees normal place of residence to the Bank, or an otherwise specified and approved location.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

TRAVELLING ALLOWANCE

Introduced October 2010

1.0 Policy Overview

Payment of a Travelling Allowance evolved out of the need for the Bank to compensate designated officers who are required to perform their regular duties off-site.

2.0 Eligibility

- 2.1 Travelling Allowance is paid to designated members of staff within in the Financial Markets Infrastructure Division (FMID) and Financial Institutions Supervisory Division (FISD).
- 2.2 The Allowance is payable to employees Levels 9 to 12 who are assigned to the FMI or FIS Division and have been designated Travelling Officer.
- 2.3 Officers with motor vehicles are paid a full upkeep, while officers without motor vehicles are paid partial upkeep.

3.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 3.1 This allowance is aligned to payments made to public sector employees in keeping with directives from the Ministry of Finance and the Public Service (MOFPS). Increases in the allowance are guided by the general increases to public sector employees.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

OVERTIME POLICY

1.0 Policy Overview

The purpose of this policy is to provide a framework for the effective management of overtime, by outlining the applicable conditions and process for the authorization of/and payment for overtime work to eligible staff. Employees of the Bank of Jamaica may be required from time to time to undertake tasks outside of their normal working hours to ensure that the mandate of the Bank is achieved. This policy is applicable to staff eligible for overtime pay as set out in paragraph 3.0 below.

2.0 Definitions

- 2.1 Overtime work means work done:
- i. During any period on a rest day;
 - ii. During any period on any Public Holiday;
 - iii. During any period in excess of forty hours in any week. Administratively work done after the end of the normal work day is treated as overtime work.
- 2.2 “Rest day” means such day of a week as may be excluded from single time work.
 “Single-time work” means work done during any period that:
- a. is not a rest day (see above)
 - b. does not exceed forty hours in any week

3.0 Eligibility

Employees, Levels 1-12 are eligible for the payment of overtime pay for work done outside normal working hours. It is the Supervisor’s responsibility to assess the need for overtime and agree with the employee the nature and duration of the work before the work begins.

4.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 4.1 The hours during which employees are required to work, are usually eight hours per day, 40 hours per week. Work beyond the 40 hours attracts an overtime rate of time and one-half. One hour is allowed for lunch during the normal work day, Monday to Friday, and in addition, a fifteen-minute break is allowed twice per day.
- 4.2 Where the work week is Monday to Friday, work done on a Saturday is considered overtime and payment is made at the rate of time and one-half.
- 4.3 Where work is done on a Sunday, payment is double the normal rate. However, if it falls within the normal work week (for example, Friday to Tuesday in a shift system) no overtime is payable.
- 4.4 Work done on Public Holidays, attract double the normal rate.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	21 MARCH 2016

OVERTIME POLICY

6.0 Administrative Arrangements Cont'd

4.5 Controlling Overtime Work

- a. Overtime **should always** have prior approval of the supervisor.
- b. The work to be done must be specifically identified by the Supervisor and expectations of the minimum output agreed prior to the work assignment.
- c. The quantum of work done during the overtime period should be evaluated to determine how close it accords to the expectations established at (b) above.

4.6 Authorizing Overtime Work

- a. The Supervisor, after ascertaining the need for the overtime, should secure the agreement of his or her Department Head. If the overtime relates to a special project, the total number of overtime hours to complete the assignment should be assessed at the start of the programme.
- b. Each Supervisor should maintain an "Overtime Record Sheet" for each employee required to work overtime; the sheet should never be retained by the supervisee.

4.7 Recording Overtime

- a. The Overtime Record Form is to be completed in every instance of overtime work, as it will form the record of the work assigned, and is an objective basis to support claims for related payments.
- b. The Form should be signed by the Supervisor when the task is agreed with the Director.
- c. Used Overtime Forms should be retained by Departments, as they may be subject to examination by the Internal Audit Division.

5.0 Administrative Guidelines for Overtime and Related Payments

- 5.1 Claims for reimbursement that may flow from overtime work are **supper or meal allowance and taxi fare or mileage allowance.**

5.1.1 Supper Allowance

Members of staff requested to work two hours or more after the normal work day ends are paid a supper allowance.

5.1.2 Meal Allowance

Members of staff requested to work for a minimum four (4) or more hours on weekends and public holidays are entitled to a meal allowance. Additionally, where members of staff are required to work during the lunch hour and would not have access to the Bank's Staff Dining Facility, they are eligible for a meal allowance.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	21 MARCH 2016

OVERTIME POLICY

5.0 Administrative Guidelines for Overtime & Related Payments Cont'd

5.1.3 Taxi-fare

Eligible members of staff may be required by the Bank to work outside of their normal working hours to ensure effective delivery of services. Staff members are therefore required to make transportation arrangements outside of their usual arrangements. In such cases, the Bank pays a taxi-fare allowance based on the actual costs to specific destinations as determined by annual surveys.

5.1.4 Mileage

Members of staff who drive their own vehicles, and are required to work on their day off are paid a mileage allowance.

6.0 Further Guidelines

6.1 Supper/M Meal Allowance

As a general guide employees who are required to work two hours or more overtime are entitled to a supper/meal allowance.

- a. Employees on the 8:30 a.m. – 4:30 p.m. shift, requested to work to 6:30 p.m. (Monday to Friday) are entitled to a supper allowance.
- b. Employees on the 8:30 a.m. – 4:30 p.m. shift, specifically requested to report for work at 7:00 a.m. or earlier are eligible for a meal allowance.
- c. Employees assigned to the second or third shifts are entitled to a meal allowance in lieu of the provision of subsidized lunch which is provided on a normal work day (8:30 a.m. – 4:30 p.m.).

6.2 Taxi-fare

Reimbursement is applicable to employees required to work later than 6:00 p.m., or on weekends **except** under the following circumstances:

- a. Employees in receipt of a car loan under the Bank's loan scheme. This exception may be waived if the vehicle is garaged for a period of one (1) week and the supervisor notified of this condition before overtime work is assigned.
- b. The employee owns a car, whether financed by the Bank or not, which is driven to work.
- c. The employee is in receipt of a traveling allowance.

6.2 Mileage Allowance

6.2.1 Mileage Allowance is payable to the employee who would not be entitled to taxi-fare in keeping with 5.1.4 above. This is payable only on weekends.

6.2.2 Mileage Allowance is calculated from the employee's normal place of residence to the Bank or an otherwise specified and approved location.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	21 MARCH 2016

OTHER BENEFITS

1.0 Policy Overview

As part of a total compensation arrangement, the Bank provides certain facilities and makes certain payments to staff which do not form part of the individual's basic pensionable emoluments. These payments are intended to assist the employee in offsetting the cost of specific items of expenditure such as work clothing, car maintenance and insurance, inter alia.

2.0 Motor Vehicle Upkeep - Entitlement

- 2.1 All employees from Levels 13 and above are entitled to receive a Motor Vehicle Upkeep Allowance. (See Senior Staff Motor Vehicle Allocation – See C.2).
- 2.2 Contribution to motor vehicle upkeep, except for the Governor, is paid monthly with the employee's salary.

3.0 Uniform/Clothing Allowance - Entitlement

- 3.1 Female employees in Levels 1 - 12 are provided with uniforms. All female employees in Levels 13 and above have the option to be provided with uniforms in lieu of Clothing Allowance.
- 3.2 All male and female employees in Levels 13 and above, are entitled to a Clothing Allowance towards the purchase of clothing for work.
- 3.3 The allowance is determined by the employee's level and is paid annually with the employee's salary in the month of April.

4.0 Accessory Allowance - Entitlement

- 4.1 All female employees in Levels 1 – 12, with the exception of Protection Officers are paid an Accessory Allowance.
- 4.2 The Accessory Allowance is paid annually in April of each year.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

OTHER BENEFITS

5.0 Blazers – Entitlement

Revised Effective 01 January 2003

- 5.1 All permanent members of staff are entitled to receive a blazer, irrespective of uniform allotment and clothing allowance benefits.
- 5.2 The benefit is issued to staff members every one and half years (1 ½).
- 5.3 The maximum reimbursement allowable is based on an agreed cost established every two years by the HR Division.
- 5.4 Amounts in excess of the stipulated maximum will not be reimbursed.
- 5.5 Payment for Blazers is on a reimbursable basis subject to the presentation of an invoice for the amount being claimed.
- 5.6 Protection Officers are entitled to two blazers on appointment and one blazer every year thereafter.

6.0 Membership (Club and Professional Association) & Entitlement

Revised November 2020

6.1 Definitions

- 6.1.1 **Club** - An organization or entity dedicated to a particular interest or activity whose objects and activities would not be a discredit to the Bank or offend its code of ethics and other guidelines/rules for conduct.
- 6.1.2 **Professional Association** - A body of persons engaged in the same profession, formed usually to control entry into the profession, maintain standards and represent the profession in discussions with other bodies. Professional Associations to which this policy applies are such associations that relate to the employee's job functions and which directly support or are aligned to the Bank achieving its mandate.
- 6.1.3 **Membership Fees** – Regular fees or charges paid to an organization at a specified time which allows the person to be considered a member or a part of the body or group to which the fee is paid. The amount paid entitles the person to be registered as a member and therefore recognised as being entitled to certain rights and privileges. The sum paid will not include additional sums for special services, additional entitlements, rights, privileges, and other obligations associated with membership.

6.1 Entitlement

- 6.2.1 Staff at Levels 22 –25 are eligible, subject to contractual agreements, but may elect to forego this benefit.
- 6.2.2 For staff at Levels 13 - 21 the Bank will pay the cost of membership in two clubs and one professional association or one club and two professional associations.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	30 NOVEMBER 2020

OTHER BENEFITS

6.0 Membership (Club and Professional Association) & Entitlement Cont'd

- 6.2.3 Staff at Levels 15 and above, in addition to the provision in 6.2.2, may include family (immediate) in one of the club memberships.
- 6.2.4 Staff at Levels 11-12 are entitled to membership in one club and one professional association.
- 6.2.5 Staff at Levels 8 -10 are entitled to membership in one professional association.
- 6.2.6 This allowance is payable on the basis of actual invoices or receipts received.

7.0 Day Care - Entitlement

- 7.1 All employees with a maximum of three (3) children between the ages of three months and 10 years are entitled to an allowance to assist with Day Care expenses for each child within the qualifying age.
- 7.2 Where both parents are employed to the Bank, the Bank will make only one payment in respect of any one child.
- 7.3 Day Care allowance is paid on presentation of the child's birth certificate bearing the name of the claimant as parent.

8.0 Property Tax and Property Insurance - Entitlement

- 8.1 Staff at Levels 17 - 21 are entitled to a 50% contribution to defray the cost of property tax and property insurance.
- 8.2 Staff at Levels 15 - 16 are entitled to a 30% contribution to defray the cost of Property tax and property insurance.

9.0 Contents Insurance - Entitlement

- 9.1 Staff at Levels 17 - 21 are entitled to 50% reimbursement of the cost of home contents insurance.
- 9.2 Staff at Levels 15 - 16 are entitled to 30% reimbursement of the cost of home contents insurance.
- 9.3 The allowance is payable on the basis of actual invoices or receipts received.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

OTHER BENEFITS

10.0 Telephone - Entitlement

- 10.1 Staff at Levels 22 - 25 are entitled to reimbursement for all official overseas and long distance telephone calls made from the officer's home.
- 10.2 Staff at Levels 15 – 21 are entitled to reimbursement for the rental of one telephone line, and official overseas and long distance telephone calls made from officer's home.

11.0 Laundry - Entitlement

- 11.1 Protection Officers at Levels 7 – 9 are entitled to use of a laundering facility financed by the Bank for work clothing.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

STAFF DINING

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank provides a staff dining facility to enable employees to obtain a balanced and nutritious meal each day. The cost of the meal is subsidized by the Bank.

2.0 Usage Procedures

- 2.1 The HR Division is responsible for the overall operation of the facility.
- 2.2 The subsidy is given to staff through a payment system.
- 2.3 The subsidy is not provided to employees who are on leave of absence or travelling on business.

SEE ELECTRONIC PAYMENT SYSTEM PROCEDURES

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

RETIREMENT

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank provides a pension and certain benefits to all employees who meet the qualifying criteria. A clear retirement policy will assist employees in planning for their retirement, accessing the relevant benefits and will also allow for effective succession planning within the Bank. The provisions of the policy are consistent with the Trust Deeds and Rules of the Bank of Jamaica Pension Fund and if differences arise the provisions of the Deeds and Rules take precedence.

2.0 Scope

This policy applies to employees of the Bank of Jamaica who have met the vesting period of ten (10) years continuous permanent service with the Bank. The types of retirement covered by this policy are:

- a) Normal Retirement
- b) Early Retirement
- c) Early Retirement on the Grounds of Ill Health
- d) Late Retirement
- e) Retirement of Deferred Pensioners

3.0 Roles and Responsibilities

The Division Chief- Human Resources is responsible to the Executive Management for ensuring the effective implementation of and compliance with the policy.

4.0 Policy Provisions

4.1 Normal Retirement

On attaining age sixty (60), the normal retirement age, an employee who is a permanent member of staff and who has met the vesting requirement is entitled to proceed on retirement from the Bank.

4.2 Early Retirement

On attainment of age fifty-five (55) or anytime thereafter prior to attaining age sixty (60), an employee who is a permanent member of staff and who is vested, may request permission from the Bank to proceed on early retirement.

Approval for early retirement will only be granted by the Bank on the basis that adequate arrangements are in place to ensure the timely resourcing of the vacancy to be created by the early retirement.

4.3 Early Retirement on the Grounds of Ill Health

An employee may request early retirement before Normal Retirement Age due to bodily or mental incapacity or physical infirmity as certified by a medical practitioner or practitioners acceptable to the Trustees, which prevents the Member concerned from carrying out any duties which the Bank may reasonably assign to him/her, having regard to the duties carried out by him/her immediately before so becoming incapacitated or infirm and notwithstanding the fact that the Member may not have completed ten full years of employment, the Trustees shall pay to the Member an immediate annual pension as outlined in the Pension Rules. (Section 5.2)

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	09 NOVEMBER 2020

RETIREMENT

4.0 Policy Provisions Cont'd

4.4 Late Retirement

A permanent employee who has attained age sixty (60) and who has met the vesting requirements, may request that his/her retirement be deferred to a date following the attainment of his normal retirement age, but in any event, no later than age 65, subject to the consent of the Bank.

4.5 Deferred Pensioner Benefits

Employees who leave the service of the Bank before attaining retirement age but have met the vesting requirement are entitled to the benefits of the scheme when they reach age sixty (60). These ex-employees are referred to as deferred pensioners.

5.0 Retirement Procedures

5.1 Normal Retirement

- i. The staff member is notified by the HR Division approximately one (1) year prior to his/her retirement date which occurs on attainment of his/her 60th birthday. The relevant Division Chief is to be notified at least two years prior to the effective date.
- ii. Discussions are held between the Divisional Management and with the Human Resource Division regarding the status of replacement strategies. If a determination is made that the services of a staff member is required beyond normal retirement age, then discussions are held at the level of the Deputy Governor with portfolio responsibilities for administration. Thereafter, discussions are held with the relevant employee, and subject to mutual agreement, the process for late retirement may be engaged or separate arrangements made for the continued engagement of services.
- iii. Three months prior to normal retirement the usual administrative arrangements are to be implemented by the Pension Administration Section.

5.2 Early Retirement

- i. The employee should submit the request for early retirement in writing to Division Chief, HR Division at least six (6) months prior to the intended date of retirement.
- ii. The Human Resources Division engages the review process to ensure that the position can be properly resourced. The outcome of the assessment will inform the decision making process.
- iii. The Human Resources Division will submit its assessment and recommendation in relation to the request to the Committee of Administration for consideration and to the Management Committee for approval. For Deputy Governors, the request will be considered by a sub-committee of the Management Committee and approved by the Board of Directors.
- iv. If the request for early retirement is approved, the normal administrative arrangement will be engaged by the Pension Policy and Administration Section to facilitate the staff member's retirement
- v. On approval of early retirement, the Human Resources Division will immediately engage the recruitment process to identify a suitable successor.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	09 NOVEMBER 2020

RETIREMENT

5.0 Retirement Procedures Cont'd

5.3 Early Retirement on the Grounds of Ill-Health

Staff members and deferred pensioners are eligible to proceed on early retirement on the grounds of ill-health or condition of a debilitating nature which would prevent them from working.

5.3.1 Staff Members

- i. The request for early retirement on the grounds of ill-health should be submitted to the HR Division along with current medical report from the attending physician supporting the request.
- ii. The Bank's Medical Doctor will consider the medical evidence submitted and make a recommendation.
- iii. Should approval of the request be granted by the Committee of Administration and/or the Management Committee, ratification is then sought from the Board of Trustees of the Pension Scheme. The normal administrative arrangements are to be implemented to effect payment of pension if ratified.

5.3.2 Deferred Pensioners

- i. The request for early retirement on the grounds of ill-health should be submitted to the HR Division along with current medical report from the attending physician supporting the request.
- ii. The Bank's Medical Doctor will review medical evidence submitted and make a recommendation.
- iii. The review process will also include the submission of relevant information to the Actuary for a determination of the amount to be paid to the pensioner.
- iv. A submission is thereafter sent by the HR Division to the Board of Trustees of the BOJ Pension Scheme for its consideration.
- v. If approved, the necessary administrative arrangements are put in place by the HR Division to effect payment.

5.4 Late Retirement

- i. There may be instances where the Bank may consider granting an extension of employment after the normal retirement age, on account of an employee's demonstrated competence level, physical capacity and the need for the employee's services. On such occasions, at the request of the employee and on agreement by the Management of the Bank, requests for late retirement may be approved.
- ii. An employee who wishes to retire after attaining the normal retirement age of sixty (60) years, must submit the request for late retirement in writing to the Division Chief, Human Resource at least six (6) months prior to the date that he would attain normal retirement age.
- iii. Discussions will also be held by the Pension Administration Section with the staff member to outline the implications of late retirement. An assessment will be conducted to determine whether the request is in keeping with the interests of the Bank and acceptable to the staff.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	09 NOVEMBER 2020

RETIREMENT

5.0 Retirement Procedures Cont'd

- iv. A submission will be prepared by the Human Resources Division for the consideration of the Committee of Administration and approval of the Management Committee. For Deputy Governors, the request will be considered by a sub-committee of the Management Committee and approved by the Board.
- v. Upon approval of the request for late retirement, the necessary administrative arrangements will be implemented by the HR Division to extend the staff member's normal period of service.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	09 NOVEMBER 2020

RETIREMENT BENEFITS

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank provides a pension and certain benefits to all employees who meet the qualifying criteria.

2.0 Scope - Entitlement

- 2.1 The scheme applies to employees who have completed ten years continuous permanent service with the Bank.
- 2.2 An employee becomes entitled to benefits under the scheme on reaching retirement age. Retirement age means 60 years or, with the permission of the Bank, at or after age 55, provided the employee has completed 10 years employment with the Bank.
- 2.3 Employees who leave the service of the Bank before retirement are entitled to the benefits of the scheme when they reach age 60, providing they worked for the Bank on a permanent basis for 10 consecutive years. These ex-employees are referred to as deferred pensioners.
- 2.4 The Bank will meet 100% of the cost for funding the scheme.
- 2.5 Under the Bank's Pension Scheme, a pension is based on one-fiftieth or 2% of the employee's annual salary at the time of retirement, times the number of years of service up to a maximum of 37 and ½ years.
- 2.6 The option of receiving a reduced pension with gratuity (lump sum payment), or a full pension, can be exercised by the employee.
- 2.7 Pension payments commence one month after the effective date of retirement.
- 2.8 Pensioners who reach retirement while in the service of the Bank, and their dependents, are entitled to participate in the Bank's health insurance scheme.
- 2.9 Pensioners are required to submit half yearly Life Certificates in order to continue receiving payments.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

LONG SERVICE AWARD

Revised October 2021

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank recognizes the contribution of its employees who have completed ten (10) continuous years (inclusive of periods of fixed term contracts) of service in the first instance and every five (5) years thereafter.

2.0 Procedure

- 2.1 Staff members are notified in writing of their eligibility.
- 2.2 The value of the award is determined based on length of service and the employee may select items of their choice.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 OCTOBER 2021

USE OF LEISURE PROPERTY

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank maintains properties for corporate events and use by members of staff. In respect of individual use, it is the policy of the Bank to allocate access in the most transparent and equitable manner.

2.0 Allocation Procedures

- 2.1 All members of staff are eligible to be considered for use of the properties.
- 2.2 An allocation exercise is carried out annually.
- 2.3 Persons interested in being considered for an allocation will be required to complete an application form.
- 2.4 A selection system will be used to identify those persons to whom an allocation is to be made. After the allocation is made, both successful and unsuccessful applicants will be advised.
- 2.5 The successful applicant will be required to make payment of the appropriate sum prior to taking up occupancy of the facility.
- 2.6 Employees who obtain access to the properties must observe all the instructions and regulations concerning the use and care of the properties. The number of persons accompanying the employee or allowed access by the employee, must be limited to a reasonable number as determined by the Bank. (See rules and regulations governing the Use of Properties).
- 2.7 There shall be no subletting or commercial/ unauthorised fundraising type of event by staff at the properties. Breach of this policy will result in disciplinary action.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

BANK ACCOUNT FACILITIES FOR STAFF AND OTHER SPECIFIED PERSONS

Revised 20 August 2018

1.0 Policy Overview

The eligibility of staff and specified persons for accessing bank account facilities, and the operating guidelines that will apply to such facilities are outlined in this policy.

The Bank provides bank account facilities to members of staff and other specified persons subject to the provisions at Section 2.0 below and the terms and conditions outlined in the Agreement for the Operation of Staff Current Account (the Agreement) and other relevant agreements governing the provision of bank accounts to customers.

Given the statutory responsibilities of the Bank it is imperative that the bank account facilities that are provided be prudently operated in order to protect the reputation of Bank and its staff at all times.

2.0 Eligibility

- 2.1 A bank account with chequing facility is available to all permanent employees and officers employed on contracts for a minimum of one year.
- 2.2 The Management Committee also reserves the right to grant approval for the continued operation of bank account with chequing facility, in exceptional circumstances, to persons no longer employed to the Bank namely, retirees and vested employees whose services were terminated by reason of redundancy within five years of their normal age of retirement.
- 2.3 Bank accounts with chequing facility may be operated jointly with persons as specified in the Agreement.
- 2.4 Subject to 2.2 above, the bank account with chequing facility will be terminated on loss of eligibility of account holders.

3.0 Breaches of Chequing Account Facility

- 3.1 The following events constitute breaches of operation of the chequing facility:
 - (i) Where a cheque drawn on an account of the Bank is returned for insufficient funds.
 - (ii) The account goes into overdraft in instances where the Bank decides to honour a cheque despite there being insufficient funds.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	20 AUGUST 2018

BANK ACCOUNT FACILITIES FOR STAFF AND OTHER SPECIFIED PERSONS

Breaches of Chequing Account Facility Cont'd

- 3.2 Notification letters in respect of all breaches will be prepared and sent to the affected account holder by the Banking Department.
- 3.3 If the account holder commits one or more breaches in any twelve-month period, the chequing account facility may be automatically terminated and the matter referred to the HR Division for further action as the Bank reserves the right to take such other action as may be deemed appropriated to protect its interest.
- 3.4 Upon the termination of the chequing facility, the account holder may continue to operate the account as a non-chequing facility. The account holder may apply to the Head, Banking Department for a reinstatement of the chequing facility after twelve months.

4.0 Other Provisions

- 4.1 This policy will not apply in circumstances where the account holder commits any fraud in respect of the operation of the account. As per the Agreement, in such case, the Bank will take all available steps to protect its interests including immediate termination of the account and other sanctions that would apply under the Bank's procedures and the law relating thereto.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	20 AUGUST 2018

GROUP BENEFITS

Approved amendments - April 2009

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the policy of the Bank to provide health and group life insurance to staff.

2.0 Group Health Insurance

- 2.1 The Bank will meet 95% of the premium for the provision of Health Insurance coverage.
- 2.2 Employees pay 5% of the premium for the provision of Health Insurance coverage.
- 2.3 All permanent and long term contract employees, are entitled to participate in the scheme. Participation is also extended to eligible dependents of the employee. These include spouse (married or unmarried), unmarried children and legally adopted children up to age eighteen (18). Unmarried children up to an age specified by the provider who are enrolled full time in a recognized tertiary institution are also included.
- 2.4 Participation is also extended to pensioners who have retired from the Bank's service and spouses of pensioners who are beneficiaries under the pension scheme.
- 2.5 Where it is necessary to claim for reimbursement, claims are to be completed and submitted to the insurance company within three months of the date on which the expenses were incurred.
- 2.6 Coverage under the scheme ceases with the termination of the employee's contract of employment, termination of eligibility or termination of the policy.
- 2.7 Where an employee's medical condition is covered under the Bank's health insurance scheme, an advance may be made to cover expenses, pending reimbursement from the health insurance company.

3.0 Group Life Insurance

- 3.1 The Bank will meet 100% of the premium for the provision of Life Insurance for permanent employees and employees with contracts for a minimum of one (1) year.
- 3.2 In the event of the employee's death by natural causes, the beneficiaries or the estate of the employee receive a payment of three (3) times the employee's annual salary.
- 3.3 In the event of "**accidental death**" the beneficiaries or the estate of the employee will receive an additional three (3) times the employee's annual salary.
- 3.4 In respect of 3.2 and 3.3 above, payment above the company's "no evidence limit" is subject to the insured having done a satisfactory medical examination, if three (3) times the basic salary exceeds the insurance company's "no evidence limit".
- 3.5 In the event of the death of a pensioner by natural causes, the beneficiaries or the estate of the pensioner receives a payment of one and one half times the pensioner's leaving salary.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

VACATION LEAVE

Revised November 2020

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the policy of the Bank to provide paid periods of absence from work for all categories of employees who have completed twelve months service. This period of absence is intended to facilitate rest and recuperation of staff members and to contribute to their overall health and well-being. In this context, employees are encouraged, as far as is practically possible, to proceed on earned leave at the time when it is scheduled.

2.0 Definition of Leave Year

2.1 The Bank's leave year runs from 01 January to 31 December.

3.0 Eligibility - Entitlement

- 3.1 Except under special and exceptional circumstances, no leave will be granted to an employee during the first twelve months of employment. In such exceptional circumstances request for leave, must be made in writing through the respective Divisional Heads to the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration for approval.
- 3.2 The vacation leave entitlement for each category of employee is set out in a matrix which is included in the manual. (See Section D.8.)
- 3.3 Leave is accrued on an on-going basis from the date of appointment. To calculate the monthly accrual, divide the number of days leave by twelve, which is the number of months in the year.
- 3.4 Staff appointed or promoted during the course of the year will receive the entitlement of leave appropriate to their rank calculated on a pro-rated basis.

4.0 Mandatory Leave

- 4.1 After the first twelve months of service, each employee must take a minimum of 10 consecutive working days leave each year. Members of Staff are however, encouraged to take a minimum of 15 days each year.

5.0 Accumulation Entitlement

- 5.1 An employee will not be allowed to carry forward leave in excess of 45 days. The Bank will pay for leave in excess of 45 days for the relevant year, in January of the following year.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 NOVEMBER 2020

VACATION LEAVE

5.0 Accumulation Entitlement Cont'd

- 5.2 Accumulation of leave in excess of 45 days may be permitted in certain circumstances (e.g. to facilitate Study Leave or extended Maternity leave) with the written approval of the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration. Request for permission to accumulate leave beyond 45 days must be made in writing through the respective Divisional Heads. Requests will be assessed on a case by case basis.

6.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 6.1 Heads of Departments will annually prepare and submit to the Head, Compensation and Benefits Department, in each year and not later than the last day of February, a programme of vacation leave for all staff in the Department for the current year.
- 6.2 The leave programme for each Department will be developed by the Head of Department in consultation with each staff member. Staff will be notified by the Head of Department of the final decision.
- 6.3 Before the staff member proceeds on vacation leave, approval must be granted by the Head of Department.
- 6.4 No employee may proceed on vacation leave immediately following a period of sick leave without the recommendation or approval of the Head of Department and notification to the Compensation and Benefits Department.

7.0 Special Conditions

- 7.1 When proceeding on vacation leave, staff at the level of Director and above and other specially designated staff essential to the operations of the Bank (to be determined by the Head of Department), are required to provide a contact number to the Head of Department/Division, to facilitate contact by the Bank, if necessary.
- 7.2 Persons who become ill while on vacation must notify the Bank and submit a doctor's certificate to that effect, if they are unable to resume normal duties at the time specified.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 NOVEMBER 2020

SICK LEAVE

1.0 Policy Overview

It is recognized that employees may need to be absent from work for reasons of illness. In such circumstances, it is the policy of the Bank to provide paid leave of absence to allow the employee to recuperate.

2.0 Scope and Eligibility

- 2.1 The policy is applicable to all employees who have worked a minimum of 110 consecutive days in their first year of employment.
- 2.2 The entitlement for specific categories of employees is set out in the matrix included in the manual. (See Section D.8).

3.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 3.1 A member of staff who is prevented by illness from attending work at the specified time shall notify his/her Head of Department within half an hour of the scheduled commencement of work on the first day of absence. If the illness persists, the Head of Department must be notified.
- 3.2 On returning to work, the employee is required to complete a sick leave application form.
- 3.3 If the illness persists for more than three consecutive days, a medical certificate must be submitted to the Head of the Department on the fourth day. Continued absence must be covered by medical certificates, as required by the Bank. While the medical certificate may be expressed in terms of consecutive days, the deduction from the employee's entitlement will be based on working days during the period covered by the medical certificate. However, leave for employees in the Protective Services Department (Levels 6 to 8) are deducted as calendar days.
- 3.4 The Bank may at any time for the purpose of granting sick leave, require the member of staff who is absent on account of illness, to be examined by the Bank's Medical Officer.
- 3.5 Where the sick leave taken in a year exceeds the stipulated entitlement, the excess will be deducted from the employee's vacation leave entitlement. Where both are insufficient, the excess may be treated as unpaid leave.
- 3.6 The Governor may, at any time during the period of prolonged illness of an employee, request medical advice concerning the employee's fitness for further service. This will be determined on the basis of a joint medical report furnished by the Bank's Medical Officer and a specialist. The Board will be advised of the final decision of the Management which may include separation from the Bank by terms to be decided by the Management.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

MATERNITY LEAVE

1.0 Policy Overview

Further to the statutory provision regarding the granting of “Maternity Leave with Pay”, the Bank will allow qualified members of staff to proceed on extended leave of absence in order to allow time for recovery from childbirth and for parental bonding.

2.0 Entitlement

- 2.1 Female employees are entitled to maternity leave with full pay, fifty-two weeks after the date of appointment.
- 2.2 A female member of staff who meets the qualifying criteria is entitled to three months maternity leave at full pay. This is extendable by an additional maximum period of fourteen weeks (by vacation leave/no-pay leave), providing there is certification from a medical practitioner that further absence is required due to the state of health of the mother or the child.
- 2.3 Maternity leave may be extended by earned vacation leave at the time maternity leave is being taken. This is not an automatic provision and requires the approval of the Head of Department.
- 2.4 No employee is entitled to paid maternity leave on more than three occasions while in the service of the Bank.

3.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 3.1 The expectant mother is required to produce a certificate from a medical practitioner by the end of the 7th month of pregnancy indicating the expected date of delivery and whether the individual is fit to continue working. A form for this purpose is obtainable from the HR Division.

4.0 Adoption

A staff member who wishes to legally adopt a child will be granted leave from her maternity leave entitlement as follows:

- 1.1 Two (2) months maternity leave for child in age group - birth to 36 weeks.
- 1.2 One (1) month maternity leave for child in age group - 36 weeks to 52 weeks.
- 1.3 The adoptive parent is required to produce a certificate of adoption.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

SPECIAL LEAVE

1.0 Policy Overview

From time to time members of staff may be required to represent Jamaica in national/international events or may be called to national duty. In such circumstances the Bank provides special leave to facilitate involvement in these events.

2.0 Entitlement - Authorization

- 2.1 Special Leave on full salary may be granted by the Governor or his designate to:
 - 2.1.1 members of staff who have been selected by the proper authorities to represent Jamaica or the West Indies in international sporting events;
 - 2.1.2 members of staff engaged in a national duty under appointment by the Minister or as authorized by the Governor or the Board of Directors. For the purpose of this paragraph, "national duty" includes carrying out duties as directors of statutory corporations or as members of public companies or the National Reserve.
- 2.2 The entitlement for the purpose of 2.1.1 above, will be limited to two calendar months on any one occasion. Any leave required and granted in excess of this entitlement will be treated as vacation leave where such entitlement exist or as leave without pay where the vacation leave entitlement of the officer has been exhausted. The Bank may grant special leave or no pay leave dependent on the circumstances.
- 2.3 For the purpose of 2.1.1 above, the Governor will have the right to grant additional leave on full salary where the leave required exceeds the two-month entitlement on any one occasion.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

STUDY LEAVE & DAY RELEASE

Revised January 2021

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the policy of the Bank to encourage employees to enhance their capacity to contribute to the Bank's mission through the pursuit of continuing education. The Study Leave and Day Release Policy facilitates the attainment of this objective. The granting of time-off from work for study purposes will be done within the operational constraints of the institution. The approval of Study Leave is at the discretion of the Bank's Management. Supervisors should, however, encourage Day Release applicants to take advantage of the Bank's flexi- time work arrangement for the purpose of time off for study. Emphasis will be placed on disciplines which support the strategic focus and operational imperatives of the Bank.

2.0 Eligibility - Scope

Undergraduate, Post Graduate (excluding Doctoral Studies)

- 2.1 For undergraduate and post-graduate studies (excluding doctoral studies), a member of staff (permanent staff or staff on fixed-term contracts for a period no less than three years) wishing to make use of this facility should have completed at least two years' unbroken service with the Bank. Applications for leave for post-graduate study will be considered only where it is determined that the course of study will enable the employee to make an added contribution to the work of the Bank.
- 2.2 Members of staff who wish to benefit from this facility must have a track record of good performance evidenced by a performance appraisal score of 6500 or higher for **each of** the two (2) years prior to the study leave application.
- 2.3 The policy is applicable to programmes at the undergraduate, post-graduate and doctoral levels or for specialized or professional qualifications approved by Management from time to time.
- 2.4 Members of staff whose normal retirement calculated from the end of the approved period of leave is less than the bonding period, will not be eligible for study leave except in cases where late retirement is approved for the applicant.
- 2.5 In cases of fixed term contracts, where the years left on the contract will not be sufficient to cover the expected number of years of the bond period, those applications will require special approval.
- 2.6 Members of staff who benefitted from Study Leave facility will not be eligible for the granting of another period of study leave until after the expiration of the bond period.

Doctoral Studies

- 2.7 The eligibility criteria outlined under 2.1 above will apply, except that the member of staff wishing to make use of this facility should have completed at least 5 years' unbroken service with the Bank.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 JANUARY 2021

STUDY LEAVE & DAY RELEASE

2.0 Eligibility – Scope Cont'd

Day Release

- 2.8 Members of staff who have less than two years' service will be considered for Day Release (with pay) only, subject to the endorsement of the Divisional Head and approval of the Human Resources Division.
- 2.9 Day Release applicants must have a performance appraisal score of 6500 or higher for the last appraisal.
- 2.10 Day Release applicants are encouraged to take advantage of the Bank's flexi- time work arrangement for the purpose of time off for study.
- 2.11 Day Release does not attract a training bond.

3.0 Contributory Leave

- 3.1 A staff member who is granted study leave will be required to contribute forty (40) days of his/her vacation leave entitlement towards the total study leave. The paid Study Leave would normally begin at the end of the forty-day period, subject to 3.2.
- 3.2 If there is a shortfall in the contributory leave, upon resumption of duties, the employee will not be eligible for vacation leave, until the shortfall is cleared. If the employee fails to resume duties for any reason, the cost of the shortfall in the contributory leave must be repaid.

4.0 Duration of Study Leave

Undergraduate, Post Graduate and Day Release

- 4.1 For undergraduate and post-graduate studies, normal study leave as may be necessary to enable an employee to complete a programme of study up to a maximum of twenty-four (24) months at full pay, may be granted to an employee at the discretion of the Management Committee.
- 4.2 Where the combination of the contributory leave and the normal study leave is insufficient to facilitate completion of the study programme, the Management Committee may, at its discretion, grant a further period of study leave of up to nine (9) months at half pay.
- 4.3 Where any additional leave is required (extended study leave), other than that provided in 4.2 above, it may be given and treated as leave without pay for a maximum of one (1) year.
- 4.4 The maximum time allowed for Day Release is one day per week or two half days per week, as may be approved under clause 8.

Doctoral Studies

- 4.5 Normal study leave as may be necessary to enable an employee to complete a programme of study up to a maximum of three (3) years at full pay may be granted to an employee at the discretion of the Management Committee.

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DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 JANUARY 2021

STUDY LEAVE & DAY RELEASE

4.0 Duration of Study Leave Cont'd

- 4.6 Where additional time is required to complete the dissertation or other courses in pursuit of the degree, study leave for a further period of up to one year may be granted without pay unless otherwise determined by the Management Committee.

5.0 Leave Entitlement during Study Leave

- 5.1 Employees do not accrue vacation leave during the study leave period.

6.0 Financial Contributions during Study Leave

- 6.1 During the period for which full study leave with pay has been granted, the Bank will make monthly interest-free advances to the staff member of amounts equivalent to the employee's basic monthly salary and allowances (excluding reimbursable allowances¹). The gratuity for contract staff will remain payable as scheduled in respect of salary received. The employee who is a beneficiary of Study Leave will be eligible for all negotiated salary increases in keeping with the terms of his/her employment contract.
- 6.2 As a consequence the bond amount shall be recalculated each year in accordance with increases in the beneficiary's salary and will inform adjustments to the bond arrangements to include the provision of additional collateral/security.
- 6.3 During the period of study leave with half-pay, the Bank will make monthly interest-free advances to the employee equivalent to 50% of the employee's net monthly salary and allowances (excluding reimbursable allowances¹).

7.0 Bond Period and Repayment Conditions

- 7.1 The specified period for which an employee must serve is referred to as the "Bond Period".
- 7.2 The bond shall be calculated at two times the period of study leave, but shall not be less than a period of twelve months.
- 7.3 The Bank will not require the repayment of advances to employees outlined in 6.1 above, provided that on completion of the course of study, employees continue in the employment of the Bank for the bond period and serve satisfactorily consistent with the Performance Appraisal System.
- 7.4 If upon termination of the study leave, employees are unable to resume employment with the Bank for any reason, advances (as outlined in 6.0) made to the employees will be repayable immediately. The advances will attract interest charges at the overall average weighted market rate² from the date of disbursement, or at such rate as determined by the Bank from time to time.

¹ Reimbursable allowances are those allowances which would normally be paid based on the submission of invoices or receipts, for example, blazer, meals (breakfast, lunch, and supper), taxi-fare, wharf duty, per diem and internet charges.

²Commercial Bank Lending Rate (Domestic Currency)

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 JANUARY 2021

STUDY LEAVE & DAY RELEASE

7.0 Bond Period and Repayment Conditions Cont'd

- 7.5 If the beneficiary of Study Leave, fails to comply with all the requirements of the Study Leave Policy and the accompanying bond agreement, such as failure to submit quarterly status reports as stipulated, the Bank reserves the right to immediately terminate the study leave, at which time all advances become payable with interest at the overall average weighted market rate³ as determined by the Bank as at the date of disbursement.
- 7.6 If an employee resumes employment with the Bank on completion of the study leave, but does not continue in the service of the Bank for the entire bond period, he/she becomes immediately liable to repay the advances to the Bank. The repayment based on amounts related to the unexpired portion of the bond period and will attract interest in keeping with 7.4 above.

8.0 Procedures/Administrative Arrangements

- 8.1 Applications for study leave must be submitted not less than three months in advance of commencement of full-time study.
- 8.2 Applications for day release must be submitted at least two months before commencement of study.
- 8.3 Applications for study leave and day release shall be submitted through the Division Chief to the Head, Learning and Development, who will prepare a submission for final approval to Committee of Administration through the Division Chief, HRD.
- 8.4 Applications for study leave must be endorsed by the relevant Division Chief, who should provide a written justification for the endorsement of the request. The Human Resources Division will review the request against the established criteria as outlined in 9.0 below.
- 8.5 The management of the Bank, subject to its operational requirements and strategic focus will determine the number of staff to be granted study leave and the course of study for which approvals may be granted within a given year. The list of such courses will be reviewed every two (2) years.
- 8.6 Employees proceeding on study leave will be required to provide collateral/security in accordance with the Bank's policy for staff loans, for the study leave bond. The collateral/security must cover the bond amount with the provision that increases in remuneration will require additional security as outlined in the bond agreement. The bond requirements will be assessed annually.
- 8.7 Employees will be required to furnish at the end of each semester certification from the proper authority confirming proof of satisfactory performance in the course of study being undertaken.
- 8.8 In the event of a failure or inability to provide the certification stipulated in 8.7, the Bank shall be entitled to forthwith terminate the staff member's study leave and demand repayment of the advances made.

³Ibid

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 JANUARY 2021

STUDY LEAVE & DAY RELEASE

8.0 Procedures/Administrative Arrangements Cont'd

- 8.9 Employees granted study leave must complete their bond period before being eligible for consideration for any further study leave.
- 8.10 The period of study leave with pay will be included in the years of service for pension purposes.

9.0 Study Leave and Day Release Criteria Summarized

- 9.1 The following criteria will be used to determine applicants' eligibility for study leave and day release:
- i. The course of study must be in keeping with the Bank's strategic priorities and operational imperatives in keeping with 8.5 above.
 - ii. Applicants for undergraduate and post-graduate studies must have completed at least two (2) years of unbroken service with the Bank.
 - iii. Applicants for doctoral studies must have completed five (5) years of unbroken service with the Bank.
 - iv. Applicants for study leave must have a proven record of good performance evidenced a performance appraisal score of 6500 or higher for each of the two (2) years prior to the application.
 - v. Applicants for day release must have a proven record of satisfactory performance evidenced by a performance appraisal score of 6500 or higher for the last appraisal.
 - vi. Applicants must contribute 40 days of his/her earned vacation leave entitlement towards the study leave.
 - vii. Applicants must be able to furnish collateral/security for the full bond amount for the duration of the study leave period.
 - viii. Members of staff who benefitted from the study leave facility will not be eligible for the granting of another period of study leave until after the expiration of the Bond Policy.

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	25 JANUARY 2021

LEAVE WITHOUT PAY

1.0 Policy Overview

Special circumstances may arise which might merit consideration for an employee to be absent from duties for an extended period under circumstances which do not fall under any of the existing leave provisions. It is the policy of the Bank to consider the merit of such requests to determine whether leave without pay should be granted.

2.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 2.1 All requests for leave without pay should be directed to the Management Committee/Committee of Administration through the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration.
- 2.2 Leave without pay will not count as a service period for the purpose of computing vacation leave.
- 2.3 Where the period exceeds one calendar month, the entire period will be deducted from the employee's pensionable service.
- 2.4 During the leave-without-pay period the entitlement to all other forms of leave is suspended and is only restored when the employee resumes duties.
- 2.5 Where the resumption of duties is delayed by illness, the Head of Department must be notified. In such cases, the Bank may require the submission of a full medical report before any sick leave is considered or granted.
- 2.6 An employee, while on leave-without-pay is expected to meet his/her financial obligations to the Bank. (See Loans Policy – Section E.1).

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

COMPENSATORY LEAVE FOR WORK ON WEEKENDS AND PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

1.0 Policy Overview

Employees of the Bank may be required from time to time to travel overseas on the organization's business or to conduct business locally on behalf of the Bank for periods which may include weekends and/or public holidays. In such circumstances, it is the Bank's policy to compensate the employee for these days by way of credits to earned vacation leave.

2.0 Travel Overseas on Weekends or Public Holidays

- 2.1 An officer who is requested to conduct business overseas on behalf of the Bank on a weekend and/or public holiday, will be granted leave to compensate for the day or parts thereof, engaged in business for the Bank. On the actual day(s) of work, the following will apply:

Travelling out of Jamaica:

Travel Arrangement	Compensatory Leave
Departure time on or before 12 Noon	1 day
Departure time after 12 Noon	½ day

Travelling in to Jamaica:

Travel Arrangement	Compensatory Leave
Arrival time on or before 12 Noon	½ day
Arrival time after 12 Noon	1 day

- 2.2 For the purposes of this policy, departure time refers to time the officer is scheduled to check in at the airport. Arrival time refers to the time the officer arrives at the final air travel destination in Jamaica.
- 2.3 Compensatory time off will not be awarded in cases where officers are travelling to or from an overseas training course.
- 2.4 The officer, on his/her return from travel, must submit an application for compensatory leave, to the HR Division, through the division head within five (5) working days of the date of return to work.
- 2.5 Applications must be supported by a copy of the relevant boarding pass and travel itinerary.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

COMPENSATORY LEAVE FOR WORK ON WEEKENDS AND PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

3.0 Local Travel on Weekends and Public Holidays

- 3.1 An officer who is requested to travel locally on business, on behalf of the Bank, on a weekend and/or public holiday, will be granted leave to compensate for the day or parts thereof, engaged in business for the Bank, if the officer is not eligible for overtime allowance. On the actual day(s) of work, the following will apply:

Time Requirement	Compensatory Leave
Work and travel in excess of four (4) hours	1 day
Less than four (4) hours of work and travel	½ day

- 3.2 The officer must submit an application for compensatory leave to the HR Division through the Divisional Head within five (5) working days.
- 3.3 Application must be supported by documentation regarding the activity conducted over the Weekend/Public Holiday (e.g. Conference, Workshops, etc.).

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

**LEAVE MATRIX
PERMANENT AND CONTRACT OFFICERS**

Revised June 2019

GRADE LEVELS	VACATION	SICK	TOTAL ENTITLEMENT # of Days
	Annual Entitlement # of Days	Annual Entitlement # of Days	
1-6	24	10	34
7-27	30	10	40
8-12 Protection Officers	30	14 (calendar days)	44

AUTHORIZED BY	MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	17 JUNE 2019

JURY DUTY

1.0 Policy Overview

- 1.1 All staff members selected for Jury Duty or subpoenaed to serve as court witnesses are granted time off without loss of pay.
- 1.2 Staff members are expected to report to work on any day or portion of a day that they are excused from jury duty, if travel time permits.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

GENERAL LOANS POLICY

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank recognises that from time to time, employees of the Bank may need financial assistance. It is the policy of the Bank to extend financial assistance to employees, within the limits of its available resources, in the form of staff loans. The staff loan regulation establishes the parameters for the granting of assistance. The following types of loans are covered by the policy:

- Home acquisition for personal residence;
- Motor vehicle purchase;
- Home improvement of an essential nature, (See Housing Loan –Section E.2); and
- Personal
- Education

2.0 Scope and Eligibility for Loans

- 2.1 Loans are granted on the basis of an employee's ability to meet the qualifying and repayment terms and conditions.
- 2.2 No employee will be allowed to incur a loan liability which will result in a take-home pay of less than 40% of net salary. For the purpose of this stipulation, net salary is defined as the employee's gross BOJ pay less statutory deductions.
- 2.3 The servicing of all debts which the employee has outstanding with the Bank and other external sources will be taken into consideration when a loan application is being processed. Appropriate disciplinary action will apply in instances of wrongful declaration of external liabilities.
- 2.4 The Bank will institute appropriate administrative arrangements to protect its interest.
- 2.5 All applications for loans must be endorsed by the employee's Head of Department.
- 2.6 Housing loans are to be repaid within twelve (12) months of cessation of employment with the Bank.
- 2.7 Where employment is terminated for reason of redundancy, a period of up to five (5) years from the date of termination of employment is allowed for repayment of a housing loan.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

STAFF LOAN POLICY AMENDMENTS

Approved effective 01 May 2017

Overview

The purpose of the policy amendments is to:

- a. Incorporate arrangements that have been the subject of exceptional treatment over an extended period of time;
- b. Support and encourage prudent financial planning by staff members; and
- c. Enhance the value of the policy in advancing the Bank's competitive position in the labour market.

The specific amendments to the Staff Loans Policy are as follows:

1.0 Take home pay

The minimum take home pay percentage has been reduced to 35% from 40% in circumstances where the Bank is satisfied that the staff member has access to additional source(s) of financial support.

2.0 Personal Loan

Personal Loans are available to staff for the purpose of funding personal financing needs, subject to a maximum limit of four (4) times monthly gross salary owing to the Bank at any one time. Loans will not be granted for the purpose of funding investments either directly or indirectly. Staff members will be required to state and provide evidence of the purpose for which personal loans are required to inform the credit review process.

Staff members are also asked to note that personal loans for the purpose of funding personal financial needs may be accessed at any time during the year, and that based on the revised limits, the loan scheme under which staff members are provided with loans in the amount of one month's gross salary in December of each year will be discontinued.

3.0 Education Loan

In relation to Education Loans the policy provisions have been amended to allow for:

- a. funding of studies at both local and foreign institutions that are accredited;
- b. provision of loans to finance undergraduate and post graduate studies for children of staff members;
- c. acceptance of guarantees from another staff member as part of the collateral for all education loans.

4.0 Major Home Improvement

In relation to Home Improvement the revised policy allows for funding of expansion in square footage of the residence of staff members.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

STAFF LOAN POLICY AMENDMENTS

5.0 Car Loan

In relation to Car loans all staff members are allowed the maximum repayment period specified in the policy, subject to satisfaction of the minimum take home pay percentage. Staff Members who are approaching retirement will be required to provide information on arrangements for liquidation of balances that may remain at the date of retirement, to inform assessment and approval of car loan applications.

6.0 Provision of Loans to contract employees.

Staff members who are engaged on fixed term, multi-year contracts, and who are executing duties of an on-going nature, are allowed access to the Bank's staff loan facilities on similar terms and conditions as permanent members of staff.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

HOUSING LOAN

See E1, Staff Loan Amendments

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the policy of the Bank to assist employees within the limits of available resources with the means of acquiring their own homes for use as the residence of the employee and their families. The method of providing this assistance is through the provision and administration of a Housing Loan Scheme. (SEE HOUSING LOAN POLICY)

2.0 Eligibility

Revised Effective 06 July 2011

The scheme is open to:

- 2.1 All members of the permanent staff who have satisfied the qualifying period of employment, as follows:

Level 2 - 6	- 4 years
Level 7	- 2 years
Levels 8 and above	- 1 year

- 2.2 The qualifying period commences from the date of the employee's permanent appointment with the Bank. However, in the case of employees engaged under a fixed term contract or series of consecutive fixed term contracts immediately prior to appointment to permanent staff the period of contracted service shall be included in the determination of the qualifying period.

3.0 Scope of Assistance

The scheme is designed to assist a qualifying employee in any of the following circumstances:

- 3.1 The acquisition of a dwelling to be used as the residence of the employee and the employee's family.
- 3.2 To finance improvements of essential nature to property owned and occupied by the employee. (See E.2, 6.1)
- 3.3 The repayment of an existing mortgage and other established debts owing on the employee's residence contracted for the purpose of acquiring or improving the residence.
- 3.5 Where present dwelling proves to be unsuitable and a replacement is required as assessed by the Credit Committee.

AUTHORIZED BY	
DATE OF AUTHORIZATION	

HOUSING LOAN

4.0 Terms and Conditions of the Assistance

- 4.1 The sum provided, for the principal mortgage, shall not exceed 95% of the contracted purchase price or the appraised value of the premises whichever is less. (A valuation is not required for a new property being purchased from the developer/builder.)
- 4.2 A certified professional valuator on the panel maintained by the Bank must prepare the valuation referred to in 4.1 above.
- 4.3 Where the assistance is provided to repay a mortgage and or related debts owed by the employee on a house in which the employee and his family reside, the advance will be limited to the stipulations under 4.1 or to the amount required to settle the existing mortgage or debt, whichever is lower.
- 4.4 The sum provided is subject to the limit imposed by the 40% take-home-pay rule, and/or, any other limit imposed by the Bank from time to time.
- 4.5 If the take-home-pay limit is not violated the Bank may, if requested, increase the mortgage to cover closing costs.

5.0 Mortgage Protection Insurance

- 5.1 All mortgagors under the Housing Loan scheme are required to participate in the 'group' Mortgage Protection Insurance Scheme (MPI), which provides for the repayment of the mortgage loan balance in the event of the death of the mortgagor or spouse.
- 5.2 In the event that a mortgagor is unable to secure MPI by virtue of ill health the Bank may accept a life insurance policy in place of the MPI.
- 5.3 Where a mortgaged property is registered jointly in the names of the employee and his/her spouse both are required to participate in the MPI scheme.
- 5.4 The Bank will pay the total premium assessed by the insurance company providing MPI cover and that amount recovered through monthly salary deductions, over the remaining life of the mortgage.
- 5.5 Additional MPI cover must be secured for any additional mortgage loan extended by the Bank, to effect essential improvements or major repairs to the premises, after the initial approval.

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HOUSING LOAN

6.0 House Improvement Loan

6.1 The Bank may extend loans to employees for the improvement of premises acquired under the housing loan scheme, or premises owned and occupied by an employee. Access to the facility is limited to the following purposes:

- i) To improve the security of the premises.
- ii) For major repairs to the structure in order to protect the property from further degradation.

7.0 Normal Repayment

- 7.1 The maximum repayment period for a mortgage loan is 30 years.
- 7.2 Where a mortgagor's age is greater than 30 years the maximum repayment period is the number of months between the first instalment due date and the normal expected retirement date, that is, at age 60.
- 7.3 Interest is charged on the outstanding balance inclusive of MPI at 3% per annum.
- 7.4 Repayment will be by way of monthly deductions from the employee's salary.

8.0 Repayment on the Termination of Service

- 8.1 In circumstances where a borrower leaves the service of the Bank other than by retirement or redundancy, the following will apply at the date of termination:
 - i) The balance on housing loans must be fully repaid within twelve (12) months of a mortgagor ceasing to be an employee of the Bank.
 - ii) The interest rate chargeable on balances outstanding at termination immediately increases from the concessionary rate (3%), afforded to employees, to market rates offered for mortgage loans by the 'traditional' building societies. Where employment is terminated for reason of redundancy, the concessionary interest rate will apply for the first twelve (12) months after termination and thereafter the market rate will apply.
 - iii) The Bank reserves the right to dispose of the mortgaged property at the end of the twelve-month period in the event that the loan is not liquidated.
 - iv) The Bank will seek to recover from the mortgagor, any residual balance if proceeds from the disposal are insufficient to liquidate the amount outstanding.

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HOUSING LOAN

9.0 Repayment on Death of Mortgagor

- 9.1 The balance on any outstanding loan will be recovered in the following priority order:
- i) Firstly from proceeds of the MPI cover or any other life insurance policy accepted from the deceased mortgagor or spouse in lieu of MPI cover.
 - ii) Secondly from the proceeds of the Group Life Insurance Policy.
 - iii) Thirdly from any amount due to the mortgagor's estate from annual salary at date of death payable under the Rules of the Pension Fund or any other source from within the Bank.
 - iv) In the absence of MPI cover, and insufficiency of funds from other sources, the Board will determine if the loan becomes payable immediately or whether to establish new terms and conditions for repayment by the surviving spouse, the beneficiary or the legal representative of the deceased employee.

10.0 Security

- 10.1 The borrower will be required to execute a legal mortgage in favour of the Bank.
- 10.2 The Bank will retain the Registered Certificate of Title, which may be in the borrower's sole name or in the joint names of the borrower and the borrower's spouse.
- 10.3 While any balance remains outstanding, the borrower is required to secure through the Group Property Insurance Policy, catastrophe cover, sufficient to fully insure the loan balance.
- 10.4 If the security for a loan becomes inadequate the Bank may request additional security.

11.0 Sale of Mortgaged Premises

- 11.1 Specific permission is required to dispose of a mortgaged property if the employee intends to re-enter the Housing Loan Scheme.
- 11.2 A penalty of 5% calculated on the lower of the original mortgage amount and the balance outstanding at disposal will be levied if the sale is within 5 years of contracting the mortgage.
- 11.3 The net proceeds of the sale, i.e. gross sales value, less legal fees and the vendor's proportion of transfer tax, less balance on the mortgage, must be applied against the purchase price of the replacement property.

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HOUSING LOAN

12.0 Application by Married Couples in the Bank

The scheme allows for a joint loan application by employees of the Bank who are married to each other. In such instances the following will apply:

- 12.1 The property must be jointly owned.
- 12.2 The amount loaned will not exceed 90% of the value of the property, subject to the 40% take-home pay requirement.
- 12.3 One party will be granted the amount applied for, provided the stipulated requirements for the loan are met.
- 12.4 If one party is unable to meet the stipulated requirements for the loan, then a joint application may be made with the other party.
- 12.5 The decision regarding which party will apply for the larger portion will be left to the applicants.

13.0 Disclosure

- 13.1 Each application for assistance must be supported by a true statement of the applicant's liabilities and normal living expenses. A member of staff already heavily committed may be debarred from receiving assistance under the scheme, and appropriate sanctions will be applied in instances of wrongful declaration of external liabilities.

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MOTOR VEHICLE LOAN

See E1, Staff Loan Amendments

1.0 Policy Overview

Loans to finance the purchase of motor vehicles are granted to staff under the umbrella of the Staff Loan Facility. The sum provided, for the principal loan, shall not exceed 85% of the purchase price or the appraised value of the vehicle, whichever is less. (A valuation is not required for a new vehicle being purchased). Staff members are expected to finance the remaining 15% of the cost of the vehicle.

2.0 Eligibility – Scope

- 2.1 All permanent employees are eligible for a loan to purchase a motor vehicle, for transportation to and from work, after one year of permanent service.

3.0 Loan Conditions

Approved Amendment 01 May 2017

- 3.1 Applications for loan assistance will not be considered at intervals of less than three (3) years.
- 3.2 All staff members are allowed the maximum repayment period which is seven (7) years.
- 3.3 It is expected that an annual valuation of the vehicle be done. In the event that the outstanding loan amount at any time exceeds the value of the vehicle, the necessary administrative arrangement will be instituted to ensure that the interest of the Bank is protected. The staff member would be expected to make good the difference.
- 3.4 The formula for determining the maximum repayment period for loans will be as follows:
- | | | |
|--------------------|---|-------------|
| New vehicle | - | seven years |
| 1-year old vehicle | - | six years |
| 2-year old vehicle | - | five years |
| 3-year old vehicle | - | four years |
| 4-year old vehicle | - | three years |
| 5-year old vehicle | - | two years |
| 6-year old vehicle | - | one year |
- 3.5 A new loan will not be granted while there is an outstanding balance on a previous loan.
- 3.6 Interest of 1% per annum will be charged on all motor vehicle loans.
- 3.7 All loans secured against a motor vehicle are repayable in full if the vehicle is disposed of before settlement of the loan balance.
- 3.8 The balance outstanding is repayable within three (3) months of the borrower ceasing to be a member of the Bank's staff.
- 3.9 Effective the date of termination of employment, interest at the market rate, as determined by the Bank, is payable on the loan balance.

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PERSONAL LOANS

See E1, Staff Loan Amendments

1.0 Policy Overview

Revised November 2010

The Bank does not normally provide personal loans, but under special circumstances, at the discretion of the Credit Committee, loans may be granted for the following purposes:

- Extraordinary occurrences such as ill-health of staff members, and his/her dependents;
- Funeral expenses associated with the death of the employee's parents or member(s) of the staff member's immediate family.
- Acquisition of essential personal household items specifically:
 - Water tanks and pump
 - Water heaters and air conditioning units
 - Electronic security (alarm) system
 - Personal Computers and Tablets

2.0 Loan Conditions

- 2.1 The loan repayment schedule is shown below and is repayable at 5% interest per annum.

Schedule of Personal Loan Facility

- 2.2 The balance outstanding is immediately repayable if the borrower ceases to be a member of the Bank's staff.
- 2.3 All loans must be fully collateralised.

ITEM	TERM (years)
<i>100% Financing offered by the Bank</i>	
Emergency medical expenses	maximum 3
Funeral expenses - immediate family	maximum 3
<i>Maximum 85% Financing offered by the Bank</i>	
Water Tanks and Pump	3
Standby Generators	5
Water Heaters and Air Conditioning Units (electricity powered)	3
Water Heaters and Air Conditioning Units (solar powered)	5
Electronic Security (alarm) System	5
Personal Computers and Tablets	3

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EDUCATION LOAN

See E1, Staff Loan Amendments

1.0 Policy Overview

The rules governing the Personal Loan Scheme now limit the facility to, assistance with bereavement expenses, relevant personal education and funding for exceptional circumstances. The Committee of Administration after reviewing the existing circumstances, agreed to create a special loan window to assist members of staff with their continuing education and the tertiary education for their children. The following factors influenced the decision:

- A critical resource for national development is the availability of a well-educated and trained work force.
- Mobility within the Bank's hierarchy will be facilitated by employees furthering their education in the various disciplines critical to the efficient functioning of the institution.
- Tertiary education costs have increased significantly and could challenge the financial resources of some members of staff seeking to provide their children with higher education.
- The income of some members of staff may exceed the Students Loan Bureau (SLB) 'income threshold', making their children ineligible for loans.

2.0 TERMS

- 2.1 The loan facility is to provide staff with financial assistance to fund the cost of tertiary and technical education for themselves and tertiary education of their children.
- 2.2 Loans to facilitate educating the children are limited to:
- Undergraduate studies at institutions approved by the Ministry of Education Tertiary Unit for access to funds from the SLB (Appendix 1)
 - A maximum of 85% of eligible costs as defined below.
Eligible costs are limited to tuition fees and where relevant the cost of accommodation to attend offshore campuses of the UWI.
- 2.3 Proof of acceptance and continued enrolment after the first year must be provided.
- 2.4 Interest is chargeable at 5% per annum on the reducing balance.

3.0 TENURE OF LOANS

- 3.1 The maximum period allowed for the repayment of approved loans is 8 years.
- 3.2 The latest end date for full repayment is the normal retirement age of the employee, that is age 60.
- 3.3 The employee's eligibility will be dependent on his/her ability to pay, as prescribed by the 40% and the minimum take home pay criteria.

4.0 APPLICABLE GENERAL RULES

- 2.1 All loans disbursed must be secured against collateral acceptable to the Bank.
- 2.2 The cost of registering the additional mortgage or otherwise perfecting the security is for the account of the applicant.
- 2.3 In the event that a borrower ceases to be an employee, the loan balance is immediately repayable but any unpaid balance will attract the interest rates applicable to ex-staff loans.

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EDUCATION LOAN

5.0 GUARANTEE OF EDUCATION LOANS

It is the policy of the Bank to extend financial assistance to employees, within the limits of its available resources, in the form of specific staff loans. The policy states, inter alia, that all loans provided to employees must be secured against acceptable collateral.

The Management Committee at its meeting of 14 June 2010 gave approval for employees to act as third party guarantors to secure educational loans on behalf of members of staff who are unable to provide acceptable collateral. This approval does not extend to education loans to staff to assist with funding education costs on behalf of their children.

5.1 *Terms of the Arrangement*

The terms of the arrangement with the applicant are:

- The Guarantor must be senior to or at the same level of the borrower.
- The Borrower must not report directly to the Guarantor.
- The Guarantor must offer to the Bank collateral to support the guarantee against which the Bank will formally register its interest.
- The collateral offered must fall within the existing loan policy.
- Use of multiple Guarantors will not be permitted.

5.2 *Special Note*

The amendment to the Education Loan Policy has not created a new loan facility; rather it extends options for the collateralization of education loans extended to staff members seeking to fund education costs for themselves.

Schedule of Institutions

	Institution
1.	University of the West Indies
2.	University of Technology
3.	Northern Caribbean University
4.	Vocational Training and Development Centres (HEART)
5.	Teachers Colleges
6.	College of Agricultural Science & Education
7.	Any other accredited institutions approved by the Bank

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SALARY ADVANCES

6.0 Salary Advances

From time to time, employees of the Bank may require salary advances to meet urgent non-recurrent expenditure. In these circumstances the Bank may consider granting approval for such requests.

- a) Salary advances may be obtained up to a maximum of 75% of the staff member’s salary; except in instances where the advance is requested when an employee proceeds on vacation leave.
- (b) Advances are recoverable from the next salary payment following the disbursement.
- (c) Applications for salary advances should be routed to the Director of Accounting Services Department through the applicant’s Head of Department.

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SPECIAL ASSISTANCE (HARDSHIP) LOANS

Introduced 26 July 2010

1.0 Policy Overview

Under the Bank's Rules and Orders, staff members are required to conduct their financial dealings in a prudent manner. It is therefore incumbent on all staff members to ensure that their personal financial affairs are conducted in a manner that will not compromise the position of the Bank, especially in its role as Regulator of deposit-taking institutions. In the event that a staff member is experiencing difficulties in servicing debt obligations to authorized external financial institutions¹, the Bank may consider the provision of a 'Special Assistance (Hardship) loan' to the staff member for the specific purpose of clearing these outstanding debt obligations. The granting of such loans will be in accordance with the provisions and procedures specified in paragraphs 2 and 3 below.

The Credit Committee operates under delegated authority from the Bank's Committee of Administration and therefore has the authority to approve applications for loans for housing, motor vehicle, education and some categories of personal loans which fall under the loan policy guidelines. When such loans are approved, a report is submitted to Management Committee, for information. In certain instances, in dealing with applications for such loans, the approval of Committee of Administration may nonetheless be required when the issues warrant (e.g. the application does not fall squarely within the applicable loan criteria).

However, in all cases of 'Hardship Loans', recommendations for the granting of these loans will be submitted by the Credit Committee to the Management Committee for approval. In the absence of a Management Committee meeting, the approval must come from the Governor or the Senior Deputy Governor.

2.0 Terms of the Loan

The term of the loan will be for a period up to 3 years at an interest rate of 5% and the loan must be fully collateralized.

3.0 Loan Conditions

The guidelines for granting 'hardship' loans are as follows:

- 3.1 the application must adhere to the standard application process (i.e. loan purpose must be clearly stated and supporting documentation appended to the application) and must meet all the terms and requirements of the Bank's Loan Policy;
- 3.2 the staff member must provide full disclosure as to the reasons for being placed in a hardship situation (including details relative to the original purpose and amount of the external credits accessed which resulted in the hardship situation) as well as a detailed declaration of all assets and liabilities;

¹ These include Banks and other licensed financial institutions, Credit Unions, Students' Loan Bureau and Hire Purchase companies.

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SPECIAL ASSISTANCE (HARDSHIP) LOANS

Loan Conditions Cont'd

- 3.3 the staff member must be interviewed by a panel (to include Credit Committee Chair, Financial Controller and the staff member's Division Head) in order to fully assess the case;
- 3.4 where the Credit Committee or any member of the panel becomes aware of circumstances surrounding the application which warrant a referral to HR Division for disciplinary action, assistance will not be considered **until** there has been a satisfactory conclusion of any disciplinary issues raised. In all such instances, the Credit Committee shall advise Management Committee before referring the matter to HR Division;
- 3.5 where there is any information to indicate to the Credit Committee or any member of the panel that there has been a false declaration (either in the application under consideration or in prior application(s)), the facility/facilities in respect of which the false declarations were made will become immediately due and payable. In all such instances, the Credit Committee shall advise Management Committee of the findings and action taken, including referral to HR Division for disciplinary proceedings;
- 3.6 where an application for a 'hardship loan' is made, the staff member must be prepared to contribute to the reduction of the debt obligations whether from sale of assets, reduction of savings or otherwise, and such proceeds must be applied against the debt(s) prior to the disbursement of the 'hardship loan';
- 3.7 the staff member must agree in writing to:
 - relinquish the credit card(s) and other credit facilities that would have caused the problem and
 - not access any new external credit facility for the duration of the hardship loan.

The surrender of credit cards/facilities must be confirmed in writing by the relevant external financial institution(s) and such confirmation must be presented to the Bank's Accounting Services Department (ASD)
- 3.8 Disbursements under the hardship loan will be made by the Bank directly to the relevant external creditor(s).
- 3.9 the staff member will not be eligible for a future hardship loan from the Bank; and
- 3.10 if at any future date the Bank is made aware that the staff member has accumulated further external debts which he/she is unable to service, or which demonstrates the lack of financial prudence, the Bank will immediately impose sanctions, which may include the dismissal of the staff member.

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MANAGEMENT-STAFF RELATIONS

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank recognizes the right to staff representation by its employees. In this regard, the Bank will enter into discussion and negotiation with any trade union or properly constituted staff association which has legitimately earned the right for such representation.

2.0 Rights of Management

The rights of the Management include but are not confined to:

- 2.1 The right to hire the most suitable persons for positions within the Bank.
- 2.2 The right to assign and deploy staff on the basis of the needs of the Bank.
- 2.3 The right to terminate the services of employees for just cause.
- 2.4 The right to plan work and schedule attendance.
- 2.5 The right to change work processes and introduce new ones where necessary.
- 2.6 The right to manage the business of the Bank in the most efficient way possible.

3.0 Staff Representation Rights

The Bank recognizes the right of the union to:

- 3.1 Exercise the legitimate functions of a Trade Union as provided under the relevant statutory provisions and the Labour Code.
- 3.2 To bargain collectively on behalf of members.
- 3.3 To be given timely information of significant decisions likely to affect members of the bargaining unit which it represents.

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank expects all employees to behave in a responsible and professional manner at all times. It is the policy of the Bank that disputes which arise should be resolved within the shortest possible time. Dissatisfaction with disciplinary actions may be the subject of a grievance under the Grievance Procedure, which is the vehicle for speedy and efficient resolution of grievances.

2.0 Grievance Procedure

- 2.1 A grievance is a complaint in writing by an employee and must be brought to the attention of the relevant parties immediately after such incident has occurred.

The Bank's objective is to settle grievances promptly and as near the source as possible. To accomplish this objective formal grievance procedures are established to deal with complaints which may arise.

2.2 FIRST STAGE

A grievance or complaint shall be presented to the immediate Supervisor or Head of Department who shall promptly deal with the matter and seek to remove the cause of the grievance or complaint if he considers the complaint justified.

2.3 SECOND STAGE

If the grievance or complaint is not settled at the first stage, then the matter should be presented in writing to the Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement, HR Division who will hear the matter. The Supervisor or Head of Department may be required to attend the meeting and the Union Delegate may accompany the worker if the complainant so desires.

2.4 THIRD STAGE

If the grievance or complaint is not satisfactorily settled at the second stage, the matter should be referred to the Deputy Governor with responsibility for Administration, or his designate who will convene a meeting with the Division Chief, HR Division, the Union Delegate and relevant parties. If the matter is not settled at this meeting then the matter will move to the next stage.

2.5 FOURTH STAGE

If there is failure to reach an agreement, the complainant may request the involvement of the Union Officer.

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

2.0 Grievance Procedure

2.6 FIFTH STAGE

If the grievance or complaint is not settled at the fourth stage then the matter will be referred to the Ministry of Labour for conciliation.

3.0 Disciplinary Rules and Procedures

- 3.1 Disciplinary rules are those that govern the behaviour of employees at the workplace, and reflect what is necessary for the safe and efficient performance of work, and what is needed to maintain good working relationships.
- 3.2 The Bank's Disciplinary Procedures apply to all employees and provide for:
- Matters to be dealt with without undue delay.
 - Indication of the disciplinary actions to be taken. (See attached Schedule of Disciplinary Actions).
 - Staff members to be informed of the complaints against them and to be given an opportunity to state their case before decisions are taken.
 - Careful investigation of the case before disciplinary action is taken.
 - Staff members to be given the right to be accompanied by a Union Representative or a fellow employee of their choice.

4.0 Disciplinary Action

- 4.1 Following an incident of any nature where it is deemed that disciplinary action should be effected, reports should be written by all the parties involved, this should be done immediately after the incident. The Bank shall have the right to reprimand, suspend with or without pay or dismiss any employee for just cause after a hearing with the relevant employee and his/her Union Delegate(s) or representative(s).

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

1.0 Summary Dismissal - Legal Basis

At common law the employer is entitled to dismiss the staff member, without notice in certain circumstances.

The employer however, has the option of waiving the breach or of treating the contract as discharged by the breach. Summary dismissal of the staff member demonstrates that the Bank has exercised its right to treat the contract as repudiated by the staff member's breach.

An offence such as theft, fraud or the deliberate falsification of records constitutes gross misconduct, warranting summary dismissal. The Staff member may be suspended from work on full pay normally for no more than five (5) working days, while the Bank investigates the alleged offence.

If upon completion of the investigation and the full disciplinary procedure the Bank is satisfied that gross misconduct has occurred, the result will normally be summary dismissal without notice.

2.0 Procedure

The relevant supervisor should first establish the facts promptly before recollections fade and, where appropriate, obtain statements from any available witnesses or persons who have knowledge of the facts or can attest to the staff member's character.

Before a decision is reached or any disciplinary action taken, there should be a disciplinary hearing at which the staff member will have the opportunity to state his case and to answer the allegations that have been made.

3.0 Preparation for Disciplinary Hearing

- 3.1 A written complaint shall be lodged against the staff member.
- 3.2 The written complaint should be examined by the HR Division to establish its merit.
- 3.3 If merit is established to the satisfaction of the HR Division, the Union is notified and through the Head of Department, a written report is requested from the staff member.
- 3.4 If the complaint is devoid of merit the case is dismissed.

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

4.0 Disciplinary Hearing

- 4.1 The Management of the Bank reserves the right to establish a disciplinary panel comprised of persons with appropriate expertise and competence to adjudge disciplinary issues.
- 4.2 The staff member should be informed of the complaint made against him and, where possible of all relevant evidence before the hearing. At the hearing submissions are made both for and against the staff member and witnesses are called as required. The staff member must be given the opportunity to state his case and to make a full answer to all complaints and the evidence before a decision is reached.
- 4.3 When the case is fully heard, the panel deliberates, records its finding and makes a recommendation to the Committee of Administration for the decision.
- 4.4 The decision is then communicated to the Union and the staff member involved in the matter, the staff member being given the opportunity of having a full explanation of any penalty imposed.
- 4.5 The staff member shall have the right of appeal against the decision. (See Grievance Procedure)

5.0 Criminal Charges/Convictions - How Treated

Criminal charges or convictions outside employment should not generally be treated as automatic reasons for dismissal. The main consideration should be whether the offence is one that by its nature makes the staff member unsuitable for continued employment with the Bank.

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

Disciplinary Schedule

The following Disciplinary Schedule details action which may be taken depending on the nature of the misconduct. These disciplinary measures range from oral warning to dismissal.

Disciplinary action is liable to be taken for the following offences as shown.

No	Type of Offence	Action Taken			
		1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence
1.	Habitually Late- 3 times in a calendar week in excess of 10 minutes each time. A lapse of 6 months between offences cancels previous offences.	Reprimand	Reprimand	Suspension 1 -3 days	Further suspension or Dismissed
2.	Sleeping on the Job	Reprimand	Suspension 1 day	Suspension 1 -3 weeks	Further suspension or Dismissed
	(a) endangering life and property	Suspension 1 week	Suspension 3-4 weeks	Dismissal	
3.	Failure to observe Safety Rules	Reprimand	Suspension 1 day	Suspension 1 -3 weeks	Further suspension or Dismissed
	(a) endangering life	Suspension 1 week	Suspension 3-4 weeks	Dismissal	
4.	Absence from workplace including early quitting without permission or acceptable excuse.	Reprimand	Suspension 1 day	Suspension 3 days to 3 weeks	Further suspension or Dismissed
	(a) where such absence endangers life or property	Suspension 1 week	Suspension 3-4 weeks	Dismissal	- do -
5.	Absence from work without permission or acceptable excuse	Reprimand	Suspension 1 day	Suspension 1 week	- do -
6.	Failure to carry out instructions given by Supervisors	Reprimand	Suspension 1 - 3 days	Suspension 1 - 3 days	- do -
7.	Gambling on Company's Property	Reprimand	Suspension 1 day	Suspension 1 -3 weeks	- do -
9.	Stealing or removing Company property without permission	Dismissal			

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GRIEVANCE AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

Disciplinary Schedule

No	Type of Offence	Action Taken			
		1 st Offence	2 nd Offence	3 rd Offence	4 th Offence
10.	Rioting – (twelve or more persons)	Dismissal			
11.	Using abusive language including/ but not confined to indecent language	Reprimand	Suspension		Further Suspension or Dismissal
12.	Coming to work under the influence of liquor and or dangerous drugs	Suspension	Dismissal		
13.	Causing damage to property belonging to Company employees or visitors	Dismissal			
	(a) Intentionally				
	(b) Negligence				
	1) minor	Reprimand	Suspension 3 days to 2 weeks	Further Suspension or Dismissal	
	2) major	Suspension 1-3 weeks	Suspension 4 weeks	- do-	
14.	Falsification of (a) reports	Reprimand Suspension or Dismissal - do-	Suspension or Dismissal	Further Suspension or Dismissal	
	(b) Attendance Register		- do-	- do-	
15.	Fighting on Company's Premises	Dismissal			
16.	Intentional slowing down of work	Reprimand	Suspension	Dismissal	
17.	Absence without communication for 5 consecutive normal working days	Liable for dismissal	Dismissal		
18.	Threats of intimidation	Suspension	Dismissal		
19.	Smoking in unauthorized areas including but not confined to a lit cigarette	Reprimand	Suspension 2-4 weeks	Further Suspension or Dismissal	

Note: It is obviously not practicable to specify all offences and the above Schedule is therefore confined to those which are more or less common to most establishments. The Bank therefore reserves the right to treat any offence against the Bank's Rules and Regulations not specified in the above Schedule on the merits of the case. As the schedule shows, disciplinary measures will be more severe if previous offences are recorded on the offender's file. Minor offences will not be taken into account for the purpose of dismissal if a period of one year has elapsed since the last offence.

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SEXUAL HARASSMENT

1.0 Policy Overview

Sexual harassment, as defined in this policy, is expressly prohibited by the Bank. Where an employee is found guilty of sexual harassment, disciplinary action will be taken which may include dismissal.

2.0 Definition

2.1 Sexual harassment includes conduct by one person to another, which constitutes:

- an unwelcome sexual advance;
- request for favours and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature where the submission to, or rejection of this conduct implicitly or explicitly affects an individual's employment;
- unreasonable interference with an individual's work performance or the creation of an intimidating, hostile, offensive or unsafe work environment.

The fact that the complainant had previously welcomed such conduct does not preclude their right to make a complaint in relation to other such subsequent conduct. A complaint may be brought other than by the person to whom the conduct was directed.

2.2 Examples of sexual harassment include, but are not limited to:

2.2.1 A persistent unwanted sexual advance such as inappropriate touching, which the receiving party indicates is unwelcome.

2.2.2 Any implicit or explicit threat directed to a person who refuses a sexual overture.

2.2.3 Any implicit or explicit promise of a benefit or a reward based on compliance with a sexual overture.

2.2.4 Any overt display of pornographic material.

2.2.5 Any persistent unwanted social invitations.

3.0 Procedure for Complaint

3.1 An employee who feels he/she is a victim of sexual harassment should make it clear to the harasser that such conduct is offensive and unwelcome.

3.2 If the conduct persists, the employee shall first make a verbal complaint to his/her Head of Department who will try to resolve the matter locally through discussions with the alleged offender and the complainant.

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SEXUAL HARASSMENT

3.0 Procedure for Complaint Cont'd

- 3.3 If the matter is not resolved through discussion, the complainant should file a report with the HR Division. The Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement, HR Division shall record in writing a statement of the complaint and shall have the complainant sign to its truth and correctness.
- 3.4 The Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement, HR Division shall, within three working days of a complaint, or as soon as is reasonably practicable thereafter, furnish a copy of the written statement of the complaint to the alleged offender and request a separate meeting with that person. The Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement shall also simultaneously notify the Department Head of the alleged offender. The Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement, shall at the requested meeting with the alleged offender, record the statement of the alleged offender made in response to the statement of the complainant and shall have the alleged offender sign to its truth and correctness.
- 3.5 On the making of a statement by the complainant or the alleged offender, they shall respectively be entitled to attend with a staff representative of their choice.
- 3.6 Where, from the statements obtained, the Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement believes that the fair determination of the matter requires further investigation and or statements of others, the Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement shall be at liberty to interview any other persons he/she reasonably believes could assist the investigations or take any further statements, as he/she considers necessary and shall provide a full report containing the complaint, the response of the alleged offender and any other statement the Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement deems necessary.
- 3.7 The Division Chief/Head, Industrial Relations and Employee Engagement shall, however, within 14 days of the receipt of the statement of the alleged offender, convene a panel for a disciplinary hearing into the matter and the complainant and the alleged offender shall be entitled to be represented by their union delegate or staff representative of their choice and to call any number of witnesses that they reasonably believe may assist their cause.
- 3.8 Where the complainant is directly supervised by the alleged offender, the complainant shall where possible, from time of notification of the alleged offender, be placed under the supervision of another person.
- 3.9 As a method of resolution of any matter herein, (if it finds the circumstances so require) the Bank shall be at liberty, in its own discretion, to transfer either the complainant or the alleged offender to another post within the Bank.

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TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

1.0 Policy Overview

The policy of the Bank is to invest continuously in the development of its staff in order to ensure the timely acquisition of the competencies required for immediate and future delivery of the Bank's mission.

2.0 Responsibility for Training

- 2.1 The Bank provides facilities and support, in the form of study leave to eligible employees, to develop themselves professionally in areas which are relevant to the Bank's mission.
- 2.2 The Bank has a responsibility to ensure that the competencies needed to achieve its mission-critical objectives are available within its workforce at all times.
- 2.3 Each Division is responsible for identifying its competency requirements, determining what gaps exist and specifying the learning needs of its staff. Divisions may make use of internal offerings from the Training Institute or from external institutions/individuals.
- 2.4 Divisions are also responsible for identifying specialized training programmes which will inform the Bank's Training Plan.

3.0 Organization of Training

- 3.1 The Training Institute is the main facility for organizing the Bank's training programmes. The programmes offered are in areas of management, economics, accounting, information technology, inter alia.
- 3.2 The Training Institute provides technical support in the areas of needs-assessment, pre-and post evaluation, and feedback.

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TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT ADDENDUM (April 2008)

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank of Jamaica is committed to facilitating the professional development and career advancement of its employees. In this regard, eligible members of staff may be selected to attend training and development programmes designed to develop officers' skills and competencies for existing jobs, as well as for future assignments within the Bank. Members of staff selected to participate in training and development programmes will be bonded for a period consistent with the duration of training received.

2.0 Scope of Training

▪ Long Term Training and Development

The Bank provides Study Leave to facilitate courses of study that enhances an employee's capacity to contribute to the Bank's mission. Assistance is provided by way of the Bank paying the full cost of the training and providing time-off from work within the operational constraints of the institution. The Human Resource Policy Manual, Section D5, contains details of the Bank's Study Leave Programme.

• Short Term Training and Development

Short-term Training and Development programmes are provided for durations of 1 day to 12 months. These programmes include:

- Local In-house
- Local external and
- Overseas inclusive of seminars, conferences and attachments

Members of staff selected to participate in these programmes will be bonded for a period of one year.

Amendments – August 2008

Bonding will not be applicable in the following cases:

- In-house training programmes of duration of one (1) day or less.
- Local external programmes of duration of one (1) day or less.
- All local programmes related to Occupational Safety and Health (OSHA).
- Staff Members making presentations at local and overseas conferences.

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TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT ADDENDUM (April 2008)

3.0 Eligibility

- All permanent and contract officers are eligible to participate in short-term Training and Development Programmes.
- For attendance at short-term Training and Development Programmes, eligible members of staff are nominated by their Divisional Managers. Attendance at overseas training programmes is subject to the approval of the Governor.
- Training courses for which members of staff are nominated must be targeted at developing and improving skills and competencies required for current assignments and in preparation for future assignments.

4.0 Provision for Attendance

▪ Local Training

- The Bank underwrites the full cost of all training programmes.
- Members of staff are paid full salary for the duration of the programme.

▪ Overseas Training

- The Bank underwrites the full cost of the programme, inclusive of registration fees, tuition costs, hotel costs, airfare, meals, per diem and warm clothing, where applicable.
- Members of staff are paid full salary for the duration of the programme.

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TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT ADDENDUM (April 2008)

5.0 Samples of Course Profile and Costing

A) OVERSEAS TRAINING COST

Course Title: Infinium Conference, California

Course Date: 21 - 24 May 2007

Travel Date: 20 - 25 May 2007

No. of Working Days: 5

Participant: (Level 14 Officer, Step 7)

Number of Training Hours: 32

Item	Description	Unit	Quantity	Rate (US\$)	Cost (US\$)	Cost(J\$)
1	Course Fee	sum	1	815	815	58,305
2	Accommodation	days	5	170	850	60,775
3	Travel (e.g. Airfare)	sum	1	1,333	1,333	95,340
4	Subsistence	days	6	50	300	21,450
5	Meals	days	6	70	420	30,030
6	Warm Clothing	sum	1	150	150	10,725
7	Transportation Airport/Hotel/Airport	session	2	30	60	4,290
8	Telephone	sum	0	-	-	-
9	Visa Fees	sum	1	131	131	9,367
10	Travel Insurance	days	6	-	-	1,060
	TOTAL COST					291,342

Rate: US\$1.00=J\$71.50

Daily Rate: (Level 14 Officer, Step 7) -- J\$8,828.14

B) LOCAL EXTERNAL TRAINING COST

Programme Title: Jamaica Employers' Federation Convention & Exposition, Ocho Rios

Programme Date: 3 - 6 May 2007

No. of Working Days: 2

Participant: (Level 18 Officer, Step 9)

Number of Training Hours: 31

Item	Description	Unit	Quantity	Rate (J\$)	Cost(J\$)
1	Programme Fee	sum	1	38,795	38,795
2	Accommodation	days	4	8,938	35,750
3	Travel (mileage)	sum	0	0	-
4	Subsistence	days	4	250	1,000
5	Meals*	days	0	0	-
	TOTAL COST				75,545

*Meals are included in the package of all-inclusive Hotel

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BONDING ARRANGEMENTS

1.0 Policy Overview

It is the policy of the Bank to institute bonding arrangements in relation to specified learning and development initiatives that are sponsored by the Bank, whether fully or partially. This is in the context that the Bank's investment in its employees in ongoing training and development to build their capabilities is beneficial to the institution.

2.0 Scope

- 2.1 The learning and development initiatives that will attract a bond, irrespective of modality include: study leave, short term attachments (2 weeks to 12 months), conferences, seminars, workshops, courses and professional certification programmes such as CFA, FRM, CIPS, CAMS et al.
- 2.2 The Bond threshold will begin at One Million Jamaican Dollars (J\$1M) for any one development initiative.
- 2.3 The bonding cost for overseas training may include a combination of registration/course fee, airfare, accommodation, per diem (including funds for contingency), visa fees, vaccination fee and warm clothing or other associated cost.
- 2.4 The bonding period for all learning and development initiatives that meet the threshold will be one year.
- 2.5 The bonding period for study leave is outlined in the Study Leave Policy.
- 2.6 The cost of the intervention will be the only criterion that will determine a bond except for professional certification programmes which attract a bond irrespective of the associated costs.

3.0 Exemptions to Bonding

The Bonding Policy will not apply to the following:

- a. Employees who participate as a presenter at a conference/seminar or any other learning and development event even if such employee is also a participant other than as a presenter.
- b. All training or learning needs assessment interventions such as the Managerial Assessment of Proficiency (MAP) or 360 Degree assessment.
- c. All training programmes relating to occupational health and safety for volunteers (e.g. Floor Wardens).

4.0 Certification Programmes

- 4.1 As part of the Bank's initiative to support employees' development, professional certification is afforded to employees in an attempt to build professional credibility, increase efficiency and expand knowledge and skills. All certification programmes attract a training bond due to the exponential value added and recognition of the certification designation (for example CFA, FRM, CIPS).

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BONDING ARRANGEMENTS

4.0 Certification Programmes Cont'd

- 4.2 All officers pursuing a certification programme will be bonded for a period of one year after completion. Where the certification programme encompasses levels, the employee will be bonded after all levels are completed. Should the employee defer or exit the programme prior to the completion date, the employee will be bonded for one year.

5.0 Conditions of Bond Repayment

- 5.1 If the employee voluntarily separates from the Bank before the expiration of the bond period, he/she shall be liable to pay the outstanding sum on a pro-rated basis i.e. he/she shall pay the amount that equates to the unserved portion of the bond.
- 5.2 If the employee is terminated for cause, he or she will be liable to repay the pro-rated amount for the unexpired period of the bond. This amount shall be deducted from any amount that is owing to the employee at the time of dismissal. If there is a shortfall, the employee must arrange with the Bank for repayment. The Bank however, reserves the right to seek recovery in the event of non-compliance with the repayment agreement.
- 5.3 If an employee's employment is terminated by reason of redundancy he/she will not be required to repay the bond.

6.0 Bond Schedule

The following bond schedule shall obtain for all relevant interventions:

Capital Outlay	Bonding Period
Below \$1,000,000.00	Bonding not applicable
\$1mn & Above	12 Months
Repayment Conditions	Full payment due if bonding period not served or, if served partially, amount due is pro-rated for unserved bond period

Certification Programmes	
Bond duration	12 Months
Repayment Conditions	Full Programme Cost (Except in cases of redundancy)

7.0 Bonding Procedures

- 7.1 The employee who is nominated for a learning and development intervention after discussion with his/her supervisor will be notified by the Talent Management Department after the intervention has been approved.
- 7.2 The provisional cost of the initiative along with bonding arrangements will be communicated via email to the nominee as well as his/her supervisor.
- 7.3 Arrangements will thereafter be made to facilitate the employee's participation.

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BONDING ARRANGEMENTS

7.0 Bonding Procedures Cont'd

- 7.4 Before proceeding on the learning intervention, the employee will be required to provide a surety in the form of a signed provisional bond letter to indicate his/her agreement to the terms and conditions of the bond which include the clause for him/her to remain in the Bank's employment for the duration of the Bond. Should there be changes to the cost of the programme, a revised Bond Letter is executed to reflect the actual cost of the learning investment.
- 7.5 Where employees are serving more than one bond, these bonds will be served concurrently.
- 7.6 The commencement date of the bond period shall be the first working day after the end of the training programme, or in the case of overseas training, the first working day the officer reports to work following the training programme.

The Management of the Bank reserves the right to at any time vary the terms and conditions of this policy.

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OFFICIAL OVERSEAS TRAVEL

1.0 Policy Overview

In the process of carrying out their jobs, employees of the Bank may be required to travel overseas on the organization's business. On these occasions, the policy of the Bank is to ensure that adequate provisions are made for the comfort and well-being of the employee. In pursuit of this, the Bank is responsible for all legitimate expenses associated with the trip. This will be done in the form of an advance or a reimbursement of expenses incurred.

2.0 Scope of Policy

- 2.1 The policy applies to all employees who travel on Bank business overseas.

3.0 Travel Information

- 3.1 Information for persons travelling overseas to attend any training event should be directed to the Director of the Training Institute.
- 3.2 Information for other types of overseas travel should be forwarded to the Director of the Accounting Services Department.

4.0 Travel Arrangements

- 4.1 In making flight arrangements, the Bank will identify the most economic route via reputable airlines, using the most direct means of reaching the destination.
- 4.2 The Bank will obtain quotations from at least two approved travel agencies.
- 4.3 No down-grading of tickets is allowed. Up-grading not specifically authorised by the Bank may be done at the staff member's expense.
- 4.4 Where an officer, because of personal preference, wishes a change in the prescribed itinerary, he/she should obtain the necessary approval from the Training Institute and the relevant Division Chief, and should pay any additional charges which might be required.

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OFFICIAL OVERSEAS TRAVEL

5.0 Class of Travel

5.1 Class of Travel for Governor

Class of Travel for the Governor is "First Class".

5.2 Class of Travel for Deputy Governors

The normal class of travel for Deputy Governors is "Club Class/Business Class". If this is not available, the officers will travel "First Class". Where the flight is scheduled to be 5 hours duration or longer, travel will be "First Class".

5.3 Class of Travel for Levels 1 - 21

- i) The normal class of travel for officers from the level of Directors to Division Chiefs, i.e. Levels 15 – 21 is "Club Class/Business Class". If this is not available, the officers will travel "First Class".
- ii) For Levels 1 – 14, travel will be "Economy Class". However, where the total flight time is scheduled to be 5 hours duration or longer, travel will be "Club Class/Business Class". If this facility is not available, travel will be "First Class".
- iii) Where two (2) members of staff are travelling on the same mission and on the same flight, the air passage for the group will be at the class of travel for which the senior member qualifies.
- iv) Where more than two members of staff are travelling on the same mission, and on the same flight, and only one person would be eligible for the lower class, the officer would be upgraded to the class of the group.

6.0 Accommodation

- 6.1 The Bank will provide accommodation for staff at properties of acceptable standard in close proximity to the place of the event.

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OFFICIAL OVERSEAS TRAVEL

7.0 Travel Insurance

- 7.1 The Bank will arrange Travel Insurance for members of staff travelling overseas on official business.

8.0 Travel Advance and Authorization

- 8.1 An advance comprising Subsistence, Meals, Warm Clothing and Contingency will be provided to the travelling officer. This will be computed on the basis of the approved list of *"Rates for Overseas Travel"*. The value of the advance will be based on the daily cost multiplied by the number of days the officer is expected to be away on the Bank's business.
- 8.2 All advances must be approved by the Governor, or his designate, on the basis of a recommendation by the officer's Deputy Governor/Division Chief.

9.0 Meal and Subsistence Allowance

- 9.1 The Bank will provide funds to cover the meal expenses of the officer on the basis of approved daily rate. A subsistence allowance will be provided by the Bank to cover the cost of laundry, travel to and from local airport, gratuities, local ground transport, telephone calls and miscellaneous out-of-pocket expenses on the basis of the approved daily rate.
- 9.2 Where an officer is attending an event such as a training course where meals are already provided for, no allowance will be provided for those days on which such provisions are made.

10.0 Contingency

- 10.1 The Bank will provide a contingency allowance to cover emergencies and expenses incurred for overseas airport/hotel transportation, departure taxes and, if necessary, travel to and from business locations.

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OFFICIAL OVERSEAS TRAVEL

11.0 Warm Clothing

- 11.1 Persons travelling during the winter will receive funds to purchase heavy warm clothing, while those travelling during spring and autumn will be provided with funds to purchase light clothing. This allowance will be provided every two (2) years from the date of the previous travel.

12.0 Attendance at a Partially-Funded Training Programme

- 12.1 Where the officer is attending a training programme for which partial funding is provided by an external agency or institution, the Bank will provide the participant with the difference where the amount funded by the external agency is less than that prescribed by the Bank.

13.0 Post Travel Submissions

- 13.1 All travel returns for advances received by the travelling officer must be submitted to the Accounting Services Department within five (5) working days of the officer's resumption of regular duties.
- 13.2 Training reports are to be submitted to the Training Institute within twenty (20) working days of the officer's resumption of regular duties.
- 13.3 Officers will not be permitted to proceed on further overseas travel and will become liable for disciplinary action where travel returns/training reports remain outstanding.

14.0 Indexation

- 14.1 Travel rates will be reviewed annually and adjustments made to reflect movements in the US Consumer Price Index.

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SAFETY AND HEALTH

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank is obligated to provide a safe and healthy work environment for its employees, customers and others who wish to use its facilities through its Occupational Safety and Health Programme.

2.0 Achieving a Safe and Health Workplace

The Bank will:

- 2.1 Endeavour to be in compliance at all times with the relevant statutory requirements covering the operations of a business and the employment of people.
- 2.2 Provide information, instruction, training, supervision and personal protective equipment to protect the safety and health of its employees.
- 2.3 Provide and maintain a work environment that is safe and free from health risks, specifically relating to hazardous chemicals, hazardous physical and biological agents, and hazardous machinery.

The employee will:

- 2.4. Perform their work in accordance with the Factories Act and other related Regulations.
- 2.5 Not endanger the health and life of fellow employees
- 2.6 Seek medical advice if he or she has been exposed to a communicable disease and advise the Bank accordingly.
- 2.7 At all times wear appropriate safety clothing, where necessary.

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MEDICAL EMERGENCY/ACCIDENT PROCEDURE

1.0 Policy Overview

Medical Emergencies are unavoidable circumstances. The Bank will however endeavour to put in place measures through its Occupational Health and Safety Programme to expeditiously respond to any medical emergency which occurs on the Bank's premises.

2.0 Procedure

When a medical emergency occurs:

Floor Warden/First Aider:

- 2.1 Reports the medical emergency to the Health Officer/Nurse
- 2.2 Ensures that the immediate area is cleared of all individuals who are not required at the emergency site.
- 2.3 Assists the employee until the Health Officer/Nurse arrives.
- 2.4 Accompanies employee to nearest medical practitioner or hospital, if necessary.

Health Officer/Nurse:

- 2.5 Visits employee at site, if employee is injured and unable to attend the Esmond Kentish Clinic.
- 2.6 Ensures that the immediate area is cleared of all individuals not required at the emergency site.
- 2.7 Enquires about the injury, and attends to staff by administering the necessary treatment depending on the extent of the injury.
- 2.8 Records particulars and ask employee to complete an Accident Form immediately.
- 2.9 If further medical assistance is required seeks the services of the nearest medical practitioner or accompanies the employee to the nearest hospital.
- 2.10 Contacts the relatives or next of kin of the employee.
- 2.11 Records all activities regarding the medical emergency in the Medical Records Book in the Clinic and makes a report to Head, Compensation and Benefits Department.
- 2.12 Follows-up on the case as necessary.

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MEDICAL EMERGENCY/ACCIDENT PROCEDURE

2.0 Procedure

HR Division Officer:

- 2.13 Requests a written report of the medical emergency/accident from employee or Health Officer/Nurse.
- 2.14 Ensures that the Standard Form for Employer's First Report of Injury is completed, and submits it along with the written report from the employee to the Bank's Insurance Company.
- 2.15 Follows up on the case as necessary.

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LIFE THREATENING DISEASES

1.0 Policy Overview

Life threatening diseases (**LTDs**) are those ailments and disabilities for which there is the constant threat of death. Some of these include *Chronic Heart Disease, Cancer, HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus) and AIDS (Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome)*. In cases where an employee is affected with an LTD, the policy of the Bank is that such persons should be allowed to continue working if they so wish. This is contingent on the employee's ability to perform his/her duties satisfactorily and provided that the best medical advice available confirms that continued employment is not detrimental to the health of the employee, co-workers or customers of the Bank.

2.0 Employment Security

- 2.1 The Bank will offer continued employment to an employee with an LTD as long as that employee is able to carry out his/her job functions in a manner satisfactory to the Bank.
- 2.2 The security of employment will also be based on certification by the Bank's Medical Officer, that continued employment of the individual does not pose a danger to the employee, or to others in the work environment.

3.0 Testing

- 3.1 The Bank may however initiate or require an employee or prospective employee to undergo testing for a Life-Threatening Disease in circumstances where management deems it necessary in the interest of the staff and/or the public.

4.0 Confidentiality

- 4.1 Information about an employee's health is highly confidential. The most scrupulous care is exercised by the management to ensure that this confidentiality is not breached.
- 4.2 Medical information received on a confidential basis about an employee's health may only be disclosed with the written consent of the individual or where the LTD is medically classified as a contagious illness.
- 4.3 Where the individual's performance is affected or where there is a potential to affect the health of co-workers, the individual has a responsibility to divulge the information to the Bank.

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IDENTIFICATION BADGES

1.0 Policy Overview

For the safety and security of the Bank and its employees, only authorized persons are allowed entry to its facilities. The wearing of an identification badge with characteristics clearly discernible to a Protection Officer is deemed to be the most effective means of achieving this objective. It is the policy of the Bank that all persons entering its non-public areas should be properly identified at all times. The policy applies to all employees and any person visiting the non-public areas of the Bank.

2.0 Conditions for Wearing ID Badges

- 2.1 Identification badges should be worn at all times whilst the employee or visitor is on the Bank's premises and should be visible to the Protection Officers on duty.
- 2.2 No employee will be allowed to proceed to his/her workstation without an identification badge. No visitor will be allowed to visit an employee without an identification badge.
- 2.3 Badges should be worn in a conspicuous manner with the face of the ID turned outwards.
- 2.4 Visitor ID should be worn in a conspicuous manner with the visitor label turned outwards.

3.0 Employees Without Badges (Amended 20 August 2004)

The following procedures will apply in instances when an employee enters the Bank without an Identification Badge:

- 3.1 The Protection Officer on duty will issue the employee with a temporary badge for that day and the employee will be allowed access to his/her work area.
- 3.2 Each incident will be recorded by the Protection Officer on duty and the information reported to the employee's Head of Department.

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IDENTIFICATION BADGES

4.0 Loss of Identification Badges

- 4.1 If an employee loses his/her identification badge, this should be reported promptly to the Protection Services Supervisor or his/her deputy in the Foyer area. A temporary badge, which should be returned at the end of each day, will be issued.
- 4.2 Other than in exceptional circumstances, a lost identification badge is to be replaced solely at the employee's expense.
- 4.3 An identification badge that has been reported lost should be replaced within two days.
- 4.4 The Bank will replace identification badges (every 5 years) at no cost to the employee or whenever the badges become defaced.

5.0 Role of the Protection Officer

- 5.1 Protection Officers may check the identification badge of an employee as and when deemed necessary.

6.0 Actions Attracting Disciplinary Action

- 6.1 The following actions attract disciplinary action:
 - i) Utilising or attempting to utilize cards declared lost to gain entry
 - ii) Wearing the identification badge of another employee;
 - iii) Tampering with an access control device;
 - iv) Lending out a personal identification badge;
 - v) Failure to wear identification badge on repeated occasions
- 6.2 A Protection Officer who knowingly allows access to an employee without an identification badge, is in breach of the disciplinary code along with the employee, and both may be subject to disciplinary action.

7.0 RECORDING OF BREACHES

- 7.1 Each Division/Department Head will be given quarterly updates concerning their staff members who are in breach. The Division Chief, HR Division will be given reports on all staff members.

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FRAUD

Revised December 2019

1.0 Policy Overview

1.1 Purpose

This policy has been developed in support of the commitment of Bank of Jamaica (“the Bank”) to protecting its reputation, property, revenue and other assets critical to the objective of accurate financial reporting; and to establish guidelines for the investigation and handling of fraud, allegations of fraud or suspicions of fraud, should they occur.

1.2 Scope

- 1.2.1 The Fraud Policy applies to any irregularity, or suspected irregularity, involving employees, (permanent employees, or employees under a fixed contract of employment, temporary employees), and where appropriate, consultants, vendors, contractors and outside agencies doing business with the Bank or employees of such agencies, and/or any other parties having a business relationship with the Bank.
- 1.2.2 The Bank's Fraud Policy sets out the responsibility of employees in relation to the reporting of fraud or suspected fraud in connection with the Bank's operation. It is intended to address not only instances of internal fraud at the Bank, but includes fraud detected in the Bank's dealings with clients and other vendor relationships.
- 1.2.3 The Bank will investigate suspected acts of internal fraud, misappropriation, fraudulent conversion, or other similar irregularity. An objective and impartial investigation, as deemed necessary, shall be conducted regardless of the position, title, length of service, or relationship with the Bank of any party who might be or becomes involved in or is the subject of such investigation.
- 1.2.4 Any suspected act of external fraud, misappropriation, or other similar irregularity will also be investigated by the Bank for its internal purposes and for reporting to the relevant authorities as appropriate.

2.0 Definition of Fraud

- 2.1 Fraud may be broadly defined as an act of deceit with the intent to obtain an unjust advantage or unlawful gain. This includes any act of deception, bribery, forgery, extortion, theft, misappropriation, false representation, conspiracy, corruption, collusion, embezzlement, or intentional concealment or the omission of material facts leading to the fraud. Fraud is a violation of trust that, will negatively impact the employment/business relationship.
- 2.2 For the purposes of this policy, fraud **shall** include but is not limited to:
 - i. Theft or misappropriation of assets owned or managed by the Bank;
 - ii. Submitting false claims for payments or reimbursement;
 - iii. Accepting or offering a bribe or accepting gifts or other favours under circumstances that might lead to the inference that the gift or favour was intended to influence an employee's decision-making while serving the Bank;
 - iv. Blackmail or extortion;
 - v. 'Off the books' accounting, or making false or fictitious entries;

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FRAUD

2.0 Definition of Fraud Contd.

- vi. Knowingly creating and/or distributing false or misleading financial reports;
- vii. The intentionally paying of excessive prices or fees without justification and proper documentation;
- viii. Violation of the Bank's procedures with the aim of personal gain;
- ix. Wilful negligence or a dishonourable, reckless or deliberate act intended to cause loss or damage to the material interest of the Bank.

3.0 Categories of Fraud

3.1 Fraud can cover many activities and while this policy is directed primarily at financial fraud as defined below there are other types of fraud which are also covered.

3.2 Financial Fraud

As used herein "Financial fraud" refers to fraudulent conduct which directly or indirectly have a financial or pecuniary impact that could be legally defined as fraud. Financial Fraud, generally falls into three broad categories and may include, but are not limited to, the intentional:

3.2.1 Misappropriation of Assets

- a. Forgery, alteration or misappropriation of cheques, drafts, promissory notes, or securities
- b. Unauthorized non-business acquisition, use, or disposition of funds, inventory, furniture, fixtures, equipment, records, or other assets
- c. Embezzlement
- d. Theft
- e. Falsifying time sheets or payroll records including, but not limited to, reporting hours not worked or a supervisor not allowing the reporting of all hours worked by hourly employees
- f. Falsifying travel and entertainment expenses and/or utilizing Bank funds to pay for personal expenses
- g. Fictitious reporting of receipts from suppliers or shipments to custom
- h. Misappropriation of Bank-owned computer hardware, software, data, or other records including intangibles (e.g. proprietary information, trade secrets, patents, etc.)

3.2.2 Fraudulent Financial Reporting

- a. Improper earnings management
- b. Improper revenue recognition
- c. Overstatement or misstatement of assets
- d. Understatement or misstatement of liabilities
- e. Misapplication of generally accepted accounting principles

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3.0 Categories of Fraud Cont'd

3.2.3 Expenditures and Liabilities for Improper Purposes

- a. Bribery
- b. Kickbacks – (Accepting or offering a bribe or accepting gifts or other favours under circumstances that might lead to the inference that the gift or favour was intended to influence an employee's decision-making while serving the Bank)
- c. Intentionally paying excessive prices or fees in absence of proper documented justification.

3.2.4 Other

- a. Falsifying information contained in employment application
- b. Falsifying information contained in loan application documentation such as identification, employment, income or appraisal documents
- c. Violation of the Bank's procedures with the aim of personal gain
- d. Wilful negligence or a dishonourable, reckless or deliberate act intended to cause damage to the material interest of the Bank.

4.0 Responsibility for the Prevention and Detection of Fraud

- 4.1 All employees have a duty to guard against fraud, to identify processes and procedures that may be vulnerable to fraud, and to promptly so inform the management of their division in such instances.
- 4.2 Managers are required to be familiar with and detect the types of fraud that may occur in their area of responsibility, and to put in place effective controls to avoid such occurrences.
- 4.3 Management shall collaborate with the Internal Audit Division, the various Divisions within the Bank and law enforcement in the detection, reporting and investigation of dishonest or fraudulent activity, including the prosecution of offenders. Once fraud is detected, Heads of Divisions in accordance with management's directives are responsible for taking appropriate corrective action to ensure adequate controls are put in place to prevent reoccurrence. Managers shall be conscious that, given the widespread use of IT systems, and the separation of controls across divisions, fraud may occur in Divisions other than those in which they are committed.
- 4.4 Employees who cover up or seek to cover up a fraud may be considered to be an accessory to the fraud/and will be subject to disciplinary action and will also be exposed to criminal prosecution as an accessory to the fraud.
- 4.5 Employees who threaten retaliation against a person reporting a suspected fraud shall be subject to disciplinary action.

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5.0 Responsibilities of Employees

Employees are responsible for:

- 5.1 Acting with propriety in the use of the company's resources and in the handling and use of company funds and other assets. In so doing employees shall not engage in any fraudulent conduct in respect of property owned by or under the control of the Bank or facilitate such conduct by other employees or third parties.
- 5.2 Promptly reporting any suspected fraud in respect of the Bank's property or property under the control of the Bank that they become aware of or have a suspicion of in keeping with this policy.

6.0 Reporting of Frauds or Suspected Frauds

- 6.1 The reporting by employees of fraud or suspected fraud is **mandatory** and should be done in accordance with the procedures set out in Schedule 1 of this policy.

7.0 Investigation and Management of Frauds or Suspected Frauds

- 7.1 The investigation of fraud or suspicions of fraud shall be handled in accordance with the procedures set out in Schedule 2 below.
- 7.2 Great care must be taken in dealing with suspected dishonest or fraudulent activities to:
 - a. avoid alerting suspected individuals that an investigation is underway;
 - b. ensure that employees are treated fairly
 - c. avoid actions being taken that could be deemed to be unjustified.
- 7.3 Details of the incident, facts, suspicions or allegations should **not** be discussed with the person suspected of fraud or any other person inside or outside the Bank unless the Bank's investigating team specifically directs this.
- 7.4 The Bank will pursue all appropriate legal remedies available under the law in respect of frauds against the Bank.
- 7.5 The Bank will seek to obtain restitution for theft, fraud and dishonest dealings which occasion loss to the Bank.

8.0 Sanction for Breaches

8.1 Overall Sanctions

All acts of fraud will be subject to disciplinary action procedures, as set out in the Bank's Disciplinary Procedures as in its Human Resource Manual.

- 8.2 Persons found to have facilitated the committing of a fraud, whether such persons benefitted or would have benefitted directly or indirectly by the fraud, will be subject to strongest disciplinary action up to and including dismissal or termination of contract of employment.

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8.0 Sanction for Breaches Cont'd

- 8.3 Persons found to have breached the procedures leading up to the committing of a fraud against the Bank will also be subject to sanctions up to and including dismissal.

9.0 Employee Records and References

9.1 Records

The Bank will cause to be recorded, in the official file of the staff member, an account of the charge, the disciplinary process, and its conclusion.

9.2 References for Employees Disciplined or Prosecuted for Fraud

Where there is a request for a reference for an employee who has been disciplined or prosecuted for fraud or dishonesty, the Human Resources Division shall respond to such requests, having regard to the Bank's policies and employment and other laws. The Bank's attorneys should be consulted as appropriate.

10.0 Fraud by Third Parties

- 10.1 Where a fraud on the Bank is perpetrated or suspected to be perpetrated by an external contractor or other party doing business with the Bank the Deputy Governor for the relevant Division along with the Deputy Governor for Administration shall review the matter in consultation with the Bank's attorneys and a recommendation made to the Management Committee for appropriate action to be taken. Such action may include termination of the relevant engagement or contract, legal action for recovery of any losses and a report to the relevant authorities for criminal action as appropriate.

11.0 Policy Review

The Fraud Policy and Procedures will be reviewed at least every three years.

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FRAUD

Schedule 1

PROCESS FOR REPORTING FRAUD OR SUSPICIONS OF FRAUD

- A. Fraud can be detected at any level within the Bank, and the following will apply in the reporting of fraud or suspected fraud:
- (i) An employee or other person who is aware of or suspects that fraudulent activity is taking place or has taken place should promptly report this, in the first instance, to their line manager;
 - (ii) In circumstances where an employee or other person does not feel comfortable raising a matter with their line manager – due to the nature of the concern, its seriousness, or for some other reason – the employee may raise it immediately with a Division Chief/Deputy Governor and in instances where these officers are the supervisors, it may be raised with the Chief Audit Executive or the Governor.
- B. Concerns may be reported verbally or in writing.
- C. Where a concern is raised verbally the employee is required to follow this up with a written communication to the person to whom the report is being made (the “recipient”) outlining:
- The fact that a concern about a fraud or suspected fraud was raised
 - The basic nature of the fraud. Details of the fraud or suspected fraud need not be included in this communication, (just the fact that a concern is raised).
- These steps are to ensure that the recipient is clear that the report is an official report and not casual speculation with no basis whatsoever.
- D. A written acknowledgement should be promptly sent from the recipient acknowledging receipt of the concern.
- E. Once a report of a fraud or suspected fraud is made to a supervisor/manager, that person is required to pass that information promptly to his/her Division Chief and directly to the Chief Audit Executive, subject to A (ii) above.
- F. Where the report of a fraud or suspected fraud is made to a Division Chief, a person at a Director level in the Bank or member of the Audit Committee such person shall in turn report the matter promptly either to the Chief Audit Executive or the Deputy Governor in charge of the relevant division.

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Schedule 2

PROCEDURE FOR THE INVESTIGATION OF ALLEGED FRAUD

- A. No investigation of a fraud or suspected fraud should take place until the Chief Audit Executive has been informed. The Chief Audit Executive, in turn, will determine who best to inform i.e. the Governor, the Deputy Governors, the Division Chief, Human Resources or the Head of Security. Internal Audit must investigate all instances of suspected frauds reported to them.
- B. The Chief Audit Executive (except in any case involving his or her division) will take the lead when fraud investigations are being conducted. This will involve data collection, analysis and intervention, including the review of internal controls. In circumstances where the investigation requires the use of technical expertise, which Internal Audit may not possess or if the case involves Internal Audit, internal specialists or external specialists may be appointed to lead or to contribute to the investigation. The appointment of external specialists is subject to the approval of the Governor or Senior Deputy Governor.
- C. The Chief Audit Executive will conduct an initial investigation to gather factual information and reach a preliminary view as to whether further action is required. The Chief Audit Executive will report the findings, conclusions and any recommendations to the Governor, the Chair of the Audit Committee and to other interested parties such as the Senior Deputy Governor, Deputy Governors, the Division Chief, Human Resources or the Head of Security.
- D. Employees who are under investigation shall be entitled to have an employee or another appropriate individual present during the course of any interview that is conducted in connection with the alleged fraud or related dishonest activity, in keeping with the disciplinary procedures.
- E. Each case will be considered individually in accordance with the expert advice available, and priority will be given to minimise losses (both monetary and otherwise) to the Bank.
- F. Where the Chief Audit Executive report provides reasonable grounds for suspecting an employee or employees of fraud or a dishonest activity, the matter should be referred to the Management Committee for determination as to what actions are necessary in accordance with the Bank's disciplinary procedures, and/or a decision as to whether further investigation is required.

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MOVEMENT OF ITEMS IN AND OUT OF THE BANK

1.0 Policy Overview

To safeguard the Bank's assets, and to ensure that employees are accountable for items placed in their custody, the Protective Services Department will maintain records of items being brought into and being removed from the Bank's premises. The records will make a distinction between Bank and personal property.

The Bank will not, however, take responsibility for any loss or damage to personal property.

2.0 Procedure – Personal Property

- 2.1 A staff member who wishes to take personal property (e.g. electronic/electrical equipment, painting etc.) into the Bank, should first obtain approval from the Head of Department. Such items should be declared to the Protection Officer in charge at the Front Desk before entry.
- 2.2 A proper record will be made of the item being brought in.
- 2.3 Upon wishing to remove the said item from the Bank, the individual will be required to identify the particulars beforehand to the Protective Services desk, so that identification may be verified.
- 2.4 Having confirmed the proper identification of the item, the Protection Officer will make the appropriate entries and have the individual sign out the item.

3.0 Procedure - Bank Property

- 3.1 The staff member must report to the Front Desk with the Divisional authorization in writing, for the item to be removed from the Bank. The Facilities Management Department will be notified accordingly.
- 3.2 A proper record, including the expected date of return, will be made of the item to be taken out. If an extension of time has been approved, the Head of the Protective Services Department is to be notified immediately.
- 3.3 Upon returning the item, the individual must ensure that the records reflect this action by 'signing in' the item.
- 3.4 Should an item be returned after the scheduled return date, the Protection Officer will do the necessary follow-up, which will include making the appropriate report to the Head of the Protective Services Department, who will ensure that the relevant individual/Department is contacted.

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MOVEMENT OF ITEMS IN AND OUT OF THE BANK

4.0 Procedure – Property Acquired Through the Bank

- 4.1 In a situation where the item to be removed was acquired by purchase through the Disposal of Assets Committee, the individual must produce the appropriate receipt to verify ownership.
- 4.2 Following proper recording and production of valid receipt, the individual will be permitted to leave with the item.

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PHYSICAL ACCESS AND PROCEDURES FOR THE PHYSICALLY CHALLENGED

1.0 Policy Overview

The policy seeks to ensure that adequate access, support services and reasonable accommodation are provided for employees with disabilities and persons who may wish to provide services to the Bank, receive service from the Bank, or who may visit the Bank for any other reason.

2.0 Physical Facilities

- 2.1 Directional signs are conspicuously placed to the front of the building, directing wheel chair visitors to the UDC Car Park and to the ramp facility accessed in the undercroft parking, with entry permitted through the East or West Gate, as directed.
- 2.2 Bathroom facilities for both males and females on the concourse level or in any Department to which the disabled employee is assigned, are modified to accommodate wheel chairs, with the necessary partitions and support bars installed.
- 2.3 The water cooler on the concourse level is at an acceptable height accessible to persons with disabilities.

3.0 Accessing the Bank's Facilities

- 3.1 Physically challenged persons, whether accompanied or not, are to be escorted by security personnel to the ramp and the service elevator.
- 3.2 In accordance with the security procedures, all such persons are to be registered with the Protection Officers at the front desk. However, a special notation indicating the person's final destination is to be made to alert Protection Officers and other emergency personnel of the presence of such a person, in case of emergency.
- 3.3 The access routes are to be retraced whenever these persons are leaving the building.

4.0 Emergency Situations

- 4.1 In cases of emergency which may require evacuation of the building without the use of the elevators, physically challenged persons will be provided assistance to exit via the staircases. This may involve physically lifting these persons down the steps by security personnel or designated officers.

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CLOSING DOWN OR PHASING OUT OF OPERATIONS

1.0 Policy Overview

From time to time the Bank may decide to reduce, close or phase out an aspect of its operations. The purpose of this policy is to ensure that when such situations occur the interest of the Bank is properly protected and the appropriate steps are taken to ensure the smooth implementation of the transition.

2.0 Responsibility of the Division/Department

The division(s) or department(s) affected by the change is required to:

- 2.1 Safeguard the interest of the Bank by ensuring that all physical and intellectual property belonging to the organization is transferred on a timely basis from the employee to the Bank.
- 2.2 Confirm inventory of all records in the possession of the employee and develop a plan and timetable for their transfer and handover.
- 2.3 Identify and recover any tools and equipment issued to the employee by the division/department, for the purpose of enabling the employee to perform his/her job responsibilities.
- 2.4 Give reasonable notice to all divisions, departments and work units likely to be affected by the change.
- 2.5 Document the changes to work processes and work flow arising from the changes and communicate this information on a timely basis to those affected.
- 2.6 Identify the impact on jobs and jobholders, review the responsibilities of the remaining jobholders, update job descriptions where necessary, and submit the necessary recommendations for changes to the Committee of Administration.
- 2.7 Arrange handover meetings with other affected departments/divisions.
- 2.8 Update policy and procedure manuals to reflect the changes and circulate to all stakeholders.

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CLOSING DOWN OR PHASING OUT OF OPERATIONS

3.0 Responsibility of the HR Division

- 3.1 Provide advice on the employee relations issues likely to arise from the phase out or closure.
- 3.2 Calculate entitlement of affected employees.
- 3.2 Meet with employees to explain entitlements on matters such as redundancy provisions, pension benefits etc.
- 3.3 Request and receive all property issued by the HR Division such as identification cards, health cards, credit cards, motor vehicles, etc.
- 3.4 Cancel all entitlements and access to benefits to which the employee is no longer entitled.
- 3.5 Ensure the preparation of job descriptions for new or redesigned positions.
- 3.6 Meet with the employee to identify other change issues and concerns.
- 3.7 Prepare and circulate appropriate communication to staff.
- 3.8 Conduct all normal termination procedures.

4.0 Employee Responsibilities

- 4.1 Hand over all property belonging to the Bank including bank records, files, reports software, equipment, and manuals.
- 4.2 Participate in briefing meetings designed to facilitate the phase out/closing down process.

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INTERNET USAGE

1.0 Policy Overview

As an information and knowledge driven organization, the Bank provides facilities for staff to access information available on the **INTERNET**. The policy of the Bank is that this access should be restricted primarily to business and professional purposes and that there should be no misuse or abuse of the facility.

2.0 Appropriate Use of the INTERNET

The use of the **INTERNET** is allowed for the following purposes:

- 2.1 Communicating with customers, clients, and business contacts.
- 2.2 Researching information relevant to the work of the Bank.
- 2.3 Accessing information for professional development.
- 2.4 Purchasing products and services on behalf of the Bank.

3.0 Prohibited Use of the INTERNET

Use of the INTERNET is not allowed for any of the following purposes:

- 3.1 The viewing and downloading of pirated software or data.
- 3.2 The viewing and downloading of obscene and pornographic material.
- 3.3 The distribution of “junk” mail.
- 3.4 The propagation of viruses.
- 3.5 Aimless non-purposeful browsing.
- 3.6 On-line gambling.
- 3.7 On-line dating.
- 3.2 On-line shopping.
- 3.3 Non-business related on-line chat.

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INTERNET USAGE

4.0 Usage Protocol

In using the INTERNET, staff members should observe the following protocol:

- 4.1 Usage should be of reasonable duration and frequency.
- 4.2 Usage should not overburden the system or create significant additional expense to the Bank.
- 4.3 Access should not be given to persons without appropriate authorization by the Division Chief.
- 4.4 Unauthorised user postings to newsgroups, internet mailing list, etc. are not allowed.
- 4.5 Personal accounts for on-line services should not be used from the Bank's computers.
- 4.6 E-mail for personal business should be used with discretion.

5.0 Access Facilities

- 5.1 Internet E-mail services will be provided to all Level 13 staff and above. Other staff members will be enrolled as users at the request of the Department Head.
- 5.2 The mailbox of each internet user is password protected to safeguard sensitive information and messages from unauthorized users.
- 5.3 The Management of the Bank reserves the right to periodically monitor employee's use of the e-mail and internet facility to determine if the user has breached the policy.
- 5.4 No visitor, contractor or temporary employee may use the e-mail system without appropriate authorization from the Division Chief.
- 5.5 Where e-mail is the only means of communication for official company records, the same procedures should be followed as would be required if the messages were communicated by hard copy, (i.e. the e-mail must be printed and filed manually).

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SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS

1.0 Introduction

- 1.1 Numerous conversations take place online about the Bank on a daily basis and we want to join those conversations, boost awareness of the Bank, its operations and functions, improve interest in our activities and direct traffic to our website, including through the utilization of social media platforms.
- 1.2 Various social media platforms have become recognized forums in which users, including corporations, communicate information and commentary via short messages with huge reach and impact across virtually all segments of the online market.
- 1.3 In accessing the value of the social media platforms, the Bank, like other organizations, recognizes that it will have to strike a balance between the advantages of being able to tap the benefits of these platforms and the need to manage the content of the communications through these forums to safeguard the Bank's image and reputation; hence, this Social Media Platforms policy. The same cautions and considerations that apply to the Bank's messaging and communications in traditional media apply in the online social media space. The Bank's policy regarding protection of confidential information, disclosures and dissemination of information remains applicable on all occasions.
- 1.4 While many may use social media platforms to spontaneously react to or communicate information, corporations recognize that the ease with which messages may be uploaded presents special challenges. These require proper protocols to ensure that the messages crafted in these short uploads are well thought through, properly constructed and are approved, while at the same time, not making the process so arduous as to defeat the purpose. Accordingly, the social media platforms approved for use by the Bank should merge seamlessly with the Bank's broad communication strategy.
- 1.5 As at the date of this policy or last revision of this policy, the social media platforms approved for use by the Bank are those listed in the Schedule to this policy ("Approved Social Media Platforms"). The Management Committee of the Bank may from time to time amend the listing by way of a revision to this policy.

2.0 Uploading

2.1 Officers responsible for approving uploads

No post or upload may be published to any Approved Social Media Platform until approved, in writing, by the Governor, Senior Deputy Governor, a Deputy Governor or such other persons approved in writing by the Governor or Senior Deputy Governor ("Approvers"). Any uploads may be carried out only by the Financial Analyst (Governor's Office), the Director of Public Relations or the Social Media Coordinator ("**Authorized Uploaders**"), each of whom will have a unique password for log-on to the Bank's social media accounts, which they shall keep private. "In writing" includes via email.

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SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS

2.0 Uploading Cont'd

2.2 Role of Approvers

Approvers shall ensure that the posts or uploads are accurate and appropriate as worded and that subject matter experts within the Bank for the particular issue have provided input as deemed necessary.

2.3 Controls

2.3.1 There shall be a **Social Media Coordinator** who shall be responsible for managing the Bank's social media platforms accounts and maintaining the passwords, profiles and settings for the accounts. These passwords shall be shared with the Executive Director, Communications under whose portfolio the Communications Department falls on the creation of the accounts and promptly on any change thereto and both shall keep the passwords private. In absence of the Social Media Coordinator, the functions of that office for the purpose of this policy shall be performed by such other person designated in writing by the Governor, Senior Deputy Governor or Executive Director of Communications.

2.3.2 There shall be maintained a proper record of:

- (i) All uploads that are posted or uploaded to the Approved Social Media Platform, including date, time, general description of content.
- (ii) The name and title of the Approver for each post or upload, with documentary evidence of approval.
- (iii) The names of the Authorized Uploader who made each post or upload.
- (iv) Such other relevant information determined by the Social Media Coordinator in collaboration with the Executive Director of Communications.

2.3.3 The records shall be maintained by the Social Media Coordinator.

2.3.4 To facilitate record keeping the Authorized Uploaders are required to notify the Social Media Coordinator immediately following uploading of the post or upload providing all relevant details and documentation specified at 2.3.2 above.

2.3.5 The records shall be maintained electronically and shall be subject to audit.

2.4 Verification of information or content

The information in uploads must be verified by the relevant subject matter expert before submitted for the approval of the Approvers. For instance, uploads regarding banking and market operations must be verified by the Deputy Governor, Banking and Currency Operations and Financial Markets Infrastructure or Division Chief, while the Deputy Governor and the Division Chief for the Research and Economic Programming Division will be responsible for information regarding macroeconomic policy. Content emanating from the relevant departments as clearly already approved or verified will be construed to have received the relevant verification from the subject matter expert and may be submitted directly to the Approvers for approval.

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2.0 Uploading Cont'd

2.5 Content of uploads

2.5.1 Uploads should not include the following:

- (i) Swear words
- (ii) Offensive or abusive language
- (iii) Slang or jargon and emoticons (or other informal expressions unsuitable for a central bank communicate)
- (iv) Libelous or potentially libelous statements
- (v) Confidential or sensitive Bank information
- (vi) Opinions on politics, sex, religion
- (vii) Issues of the day not specific to Bank of Jamaica

2.5.2 Uploads should:

- (i) Conform with the Bank's privacy policy
- (ii) Be relevant and compelling
- (iii) Be concise - limited to 140 characters in the case of tweets
- (iv) Use images in compliance with the relevant copyright laws
- (v) Use hashtags in accordance with the rules at 2.5.1 above

2.5.3 Content can include:

- (i) News and Press Releases
- (ii) Sound bites from or videos of speeches
- (iii) Innovations, e.g., B-FXITT
- (iv) New content on the Bank's website
- (v) Upcoming events, coverage of events
- (vi) Links to relevant and approved blogs or uploads
- (vii) Recommendations from divisions or departments, including matters of a topical nature or key issues relating to the divisions or the Bank as a whole

2.5.4 **Uploads should not be vague, ambiguous or contradictory.** Before an upload is made ensure that all points have been adequately covered.

2.5.5 Interpretation

As used in this policy "posts" or "uploads" includes not only original social media platforms messages, posts or uploads but also re-uploaded messages (such as retweets or re-posts), responses to posts or uploads, actions to "follow" other social media accountholders or any other communications actions or activities via social media platforms including also but not limited to the use of photographs, videos, Graphic Interchange Formats (GIFS) or other formats.

3.0 Official Branding

The Bank's social media platforms accounts should be clearly branded as official accounts of the Bank and should be so listed on the homepage of the Bank's website.

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4.0 Frequency of Uploadings and Responses to Uploads

- 4.1 Good social media platform feeds are expected to have a steady stream of content or structured uploads. Updates should be timely, relevant and useful and adhere to a formal documented schedule.
- 4.2 Responses to uploads should not be automatic but should only be made where necessary. Re-posting of relevant content and replies to comments and criticisms should be prompt and should not be written in a way that looks like the expression of one's personal opinion.

5.0 Employees' Personal Social Media Platforms Accounts

- 5.1 The use of personal social media platforms accounts as the Bank's official social media platforms account is absolutely prohibited.
- 5.2 Employees who have social media accounts should avoid making any commentary with respect to the Bank or its operations which could be seen as representing the position of the Bank and should make it clear that they are not official spokespersons for the Bank and that their posts, tweets, uploads, opinions or other uploaded content are theirs and only theirs.
- 5.3 The Bank's logo should not be used by employees on their social media accounts.

6.0 Following Others on Twitter or Other Social Media Platform

With respect to Twitter or other relevant social media platform that accommodates this, the Bank will not automatically follow its followers. If the Bank follows an individual or a company no endorsement is implied or should be suggested to be implied.

7.0 Availability

The Bank will update and monitor its social media platforms accounts, Mondays to Fridays, during office hours. On occasion the social media platforms services may be unavailable; the Bank will make clear that it accepts no responsibility for a lack of service as a result of social media platforms' downtime.

8.0 Deleting Uploads

Of note is that deletion of uploads removes the upload only from Twitter.com or Facebook.com or the other social media platforms as the case may be. Uploads on social media platforms that have been retweeted, reposted or re-uploaded by another user will remain publicly visible.

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SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS

9.0 Corrections

Erroneous uploads need to be corrected quickly and transparently as errors with an upload indicating the mistake.

10.0 Breaches

All members of staff have an obligation not to breach this policy and to report actual or potential breach. This allows us to:

- i. Investigate and take steps if necessary
- ii. Maintain a register of compliance failures
- iii. Notify the senior management of any compliance failures that are material to the Bank

10.0 Breaches Cont'd

Breaches of this policy and failure to report such breaches may result in disciplinary action in accordance with Bank's Grievance and Disciplinary Policy.

11.0 Monitoring and Evaluation

The engagement of followers on the social media platforms should be measured using the relevant tools such as the tweet activity dashboard. Bank of Jamaica Social Media Platforms Policy

12.0 Schedule

"Approved Social Media Platforms" as used in this policy refers to social media platforms approved by the Management Committee of the Bank. As at the date of the last revision to this policy, the approved social media platforms are:

- (i) Twitter
- (ii) Facebook
- (iii) YouTube

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ENDORSEMENTS

1.0 Policy Overview

Staff members may endorse products, services and events of a commercial or non-commercial nature provided this does not:

- 1.1 Interfere with the employee's ability to perform his/her regular job responsibilities.
- 1.2 Breach the policies and procedures relating to conflict of interest.
- 1.3 Have a negative impact on the reputation of the Bank.
- 1.4 Expose the Bank to embarrassment and/or criticism.

2.0 Activities Covered by the Policy

- 2.1 Endorsement of commercial products and services.
- 2.2 Endorsement of for-profit or not-for profit organization.
- 2.3 Endorsement of special events.
- 2.4 Endorsement of promotional campaigns.

3.0 Forms of Endorsements

The policy refers to:

- 3.1 Appearance in advertisements for airing or broadcast in the electronic media.
- 3.2 Appearance in advertisements in the print media.
- 3.4 Appearance on a public stage. E.g. Political platform.

4.0 Disclosure and Approval Procedure

Whenever activities falling in any of the above categories are contemplated the employee is required to:

- 4.1 Inform his/her line manager in writing within a reasonable time before the commencement of the proposed endorsement.

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ENDORSEMENTS

4.0 Disclosure and Approval Procedure

- 4.2 Provide information on the nature of the proposed endorsement.
- 4.3 Submit request to Manager regarding the proposed endorsement.

Line Manager will conduct the necessary investigation and advise the applicant of the Bank's decision.

5.0 Requests Falling in any of the Following Categories will not be Approved

- 5.1 Endorsements of organizations supervised and regulated by the Bank.
- 5.2 Endorsement of organizations covered by the Financial Services Act.
- 5.3 Endorsement of political parties or movements.
- 5.4 Endorsement of organizations providing direct services to the Bank.
- 5.5 Endorsement of contractors and consultants associated with, or relevant to the Bank's operations.
- 5.6 The Bank reserves the right to amend these categories from time to time.

6.0 Requests will not be Approved in Situations Where:

- 6.1 The time required to participate in an endorsement activity will result in undue disruption to the work carried out by the employee.
- 6.2 The employee is required to include the name of the Bank as a part of the endorsement contract and activities.
- 6.3 The employee is required to use the endorsed products or services in the performance of his/her job with the Bank.
- 6.4 The employee is required to provide confidential information about the operations of the Bank and/or any of the entities falling under its regulatory control.

7.0 Breach of the Policy

- 7.1 Any breach of the above guidelines will be cause for disciplinary action.

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DEATH OF STAFF MEMBER/PENSIONER

1.0 Policy Overview

In instances where a present member of staff or a pensioner dies, it is the policy of the Bank to acknowledge the event and to extend assistance to the bereaved family where necessary, in a prompt, caring and sensitive manner.

2.0 Related Procedures

- 2.1 The Division Chief of the HR Division will be responsible for making contact with the family of the deceased to ascertain and agree on the role, if any, which the Bank will play in the funeral arrangements and funeral proceedings.
- 2.2 Where financial assistance is requested, this will be accommodated on the basis of recovery via the proceeds of life insurance benefits which will become available.
- 2.3 As far as is practical, such assistance will take the form of direct payment to the providers of funeral services such as undertakers, subject to the approval of the beneficiary of the policy.
- 2.4 Appropriate acknowledgment of the event will take the form of, among other things, internal announcements, observance of silence, and the flying of the Bank's flag at half mast up to the day of the funeral.
- 2.5 Following the funeral, the HR Division is responsible for executing various administrative arrangements. These include the settlement of life insurance claims, the clearance of outstanding obligations to the Bank and the payment of pension to surviving beneficiaries, if the deceased is qualified under the terms and conditions of the scheme.

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SMOKING

1.0 Policy Overview

Smoking is a health-impairing social habit. Accordingly it is prohibited in enclosed areas of the building. While on Bank business, employees are expected to observe the smoking policy of the institution/organisation in which they are conducting business.

2.0 Smoking Within the Bank

2.1 Smoking is not allowed in enclosed areas on the Bank’s premises.

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DRUGS AND ALCOHOL

1.0 Possession/Use/Sale

- 1.1 The possession, use or sale of illegal drugs by an employee is prohibited. Any breach of this policy will result in strong disciplinary action up to and including dismissal.
- 1.2 Alcohol consumption on the Bank's premises may only be allowed, at official events hosted by the Bank, at Bank-related functions and at the Bank's Recreational Facility after working hours, in such amounts which ensure an acceptable level of sobriety by the employee.
- 1.3 Alcohol consumption at other official Bank functions or when representing the Bank must be under similar circumstances as above.

2.0 Testing

- 2.1 The Bank reserves the right to test employees for the use of illegal drugs and the excessive use of alcohol where there is reasonable suspicion that these substances are being used and/or abused.
- 2.2 In the case of drug testing, the employee will be directed to a medical facility where testing will be done.
- 2.3 If an employee returns a positive test, the Bank reserves the right to remove that employee from his/her regular duties. The Bank will facilitate a rehabilitation programme for the employee. At the end of the programme, the employee will be assessed by the Bank's Medical Officer to verify his/her capability to resume previous duties.

3.0 Rehabilitation

- 3.1 The Bank recognizes drug and alcohol dependency as a treatable illness. Employees who develop such dependencies will be required to seek professional attention.
- 3.2 The Bank will, where necessary, use reasonable efforts to assist the employee within the limits of its capability to access the necessary treatment.
- 3.3 Employees who admit to their illness, take ownership of their rehabilitation and faithfully follow the prescribed remedial measures, will not place their employment with the Bank in jeopardy. This however does not rule out the possibility of the assignment of alternative work for which the employee might be better suited under the circumstances.
- 3.4 Failure to follow a prescribed treatment plan resulting in inappropriate behaviour or unacceptable level of performance may be a basis for disciplinary action including termination.

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FIREARMS POLICY

1.0 Policy Overview

The Bank recognizes that a safe and secure environment for staff, visitors, and the physical plant is a fundamental prerequisite for fulfilling its mandate. Accordingly, the Bank is committed to maintaining a workplace that is free of violence and the threat of violence.

2.0 Scope

- 2.1 It is the policy of the Bank of Jamaica (BOJ) that no firearms are permitted beyond the security screening area/concourse floor except in the circumstances outlined hereunder:
 - 2.1.1 Bank of Jamaica's Protective Services staff who are required to carry a firearm in accordance with his or her duties.
 - 2.1.2 Law enforcement officers (Jamaica Constabulary Force and Military) who are visiting the Bank in an official capacity.
 - 2.1.3 Officers who provide personal executive protection for Government officials, diplomats, and other visiting dignitaries.
- 2.2 In order for the necessary security arrangements to be made, senior officers are required to inform the Director, Protective Services, in advance of VIP visitors, and if officers providing personal protection will accompany such visitors.
- 2.3 A secure storage area (lockers) is provided for the use of persons not mentioned in 2.1 above, and who are in possession of firearms.
- 2.4 Members of staff who are licensed firearm holders will be facilitated with individual security lockers (pistol lockers) for storage of firearm while at work.

3.0 Administrative Arrangements

- 3.1 All firearms under license to the Bank of Jamaica must be kept in the Bank's Armoury when not assigned to a Protection Officer on duty.
- 3.2 Firearms issued to the Protective Services Officers should be in conformity with the officer's approved status; that is, the type of firearm permitted by the Bank and under license of Government authorities.
- 3.3 Except under extreme circumstances persons not achieving the minimum range scores set by the Bank will not be permitted to carry firearms while on duty.
- 3.4 Other members of staff who are licensed firearms holders should make declarations to the Director, Protective Services Department. The firearm should be stored in the pistol lockers located in the room provided in the Concourse under dual security arrangements.

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FIREARMS POLICY

3.0 Administrative Arrangements Cont'd

- 3.5 Law enforcement officers, who provide personal security protection services to Government officials, diplomats and other dignitaries, may be permitted to enter the building and allowed access to designated areas.
- 3.6 Law enforcement officers of the Jamaica Constabulary Force and the Jamaica Defense Force who are not providing personal security will be permitted to carry their firearms to designated areas of business **ONLY** in the company of a Protective Services officer.
- 3.7 Private security officers (couriers) will be allowed in the Bullion area of the Currency Department or any other area identified as imperative to the execution of their business with the Bank of Jamaica. As far as possible, the interface between members of the Currency Department and couriers **WILL** be minimized.
- 3.8 Other licensed firearm holders who are conducting business with the Bank of Jamaica may be permitted to enter the premises **ONLY** with the expressed permission of the Director, Protective Services Department.

4.0 Breach of Policy

- 4.0 Persons who contravene these directives will be subject to disciplinary action.

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